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Hot global markets, narrow bets: India stands apart

DIVERSE PLAY. India's relative appeal lies not as much in runaway returns as in the breadth of its market exposure

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Would investors rather back a diversified market, or saddle up on a one-trick pony with a shiny AI chip on its mane? Strangely enough, many global funds seem to be choosing the pony.

Overseas investors have flocked to markets such as Taiwan and South Korea in 2025-26, riding the boom in artificial intelligence, semiconductors and related technologies. But a closer look at the composition of some of the world's best-performing equity markets suggests that investors buying these country indices are often making concentrated bets on a handful of companies rather than gaining exposure to broad-based economic growth.

Data from MSCI country indices show that India stands apart as one of the least concentrated major equity markets globally. While many high-performing markets are dominated by a single stock or sector (*see charts*), India's benchmark remains relatively diversified across companies and industries.

The analysis is based on MSCI country price return indices, with returns measured

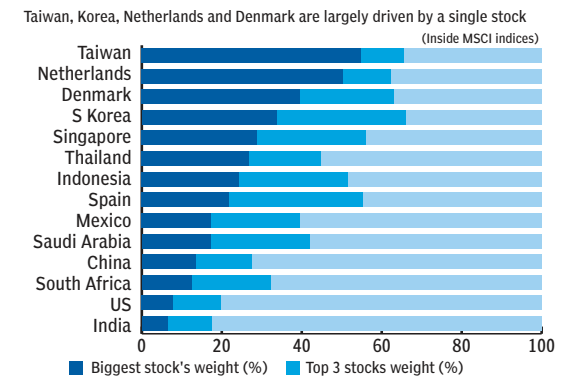
in US dollar terms for the one-year period ended June 11, 2026. MSCI's country-specific indices are designed to capture about 85 per cent of the free-float-adjusted market capitalisation of each market.

SINGLE-STOCK MARKETS Taiwan offers perhaps the clearest example of market concentration. The MSCI Taiwan Index delivered a strong 93.1 per cent return over the past year. Yet, Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (TSMC) alone accounts for 54.8 per cent of the benchmark. The stock itself gained 99.8 per cent during the period, underscoring how closely the market's performance is tied to a single corporate giant.

South Korea presents an even starker picture. The MSCI Korea Index surged 200.4 per cent over the past year, led by Samsung Electronics, which carries a weight of 33.7 per cent and rallied 356.6 per cent. The top three stocks together account for 66.1 per cent of the benchmark.

The same pattern is visible elsewhere. ASML Holding represents nearly 50 per cent of the MSCI Netherlands Index, while Novo Nordisk accounts for 40 per cent of the

When one stock drives a whole market



MSCI Denmark Index. In Singapore, DBS Group carries a weight of 29 per cent, while Bank Central Asia commands more than 24 per cent of Indonesia's benchmark.

Such concentration has worked exceptionally well when the dominant company is aligned with a powerful global investment theme. Taiwan's outperformance has coincided with soaring demand for AI chips, while Korea has benefited from investor enthusiasm for memory semiconductors and electronics. Investors may believe they are diversifying internationally, but in many cases they are effectively backing a small number of corporate champions.

Bloomberg-derived earnings

growth estimates for MSCI country indices suggest India may grow slower than peers such as the US, Taiwan, Korea and the Netherlands in FY27, but where such growth is dependent on a handful of stocks or one-two sectors, it can change quickly if fortunes reverse. Foreign portfolio investors, who have already sold Indian equities worth over \$30 billion this year, may well take note of this vulnerability.

INDIA'S BROADER MARKET India offers a markedly different proposition. The largest stock in the MSCI India Index, HDFC Bank, accounts for only 6.4 per cent of the benchmark. The top three stocks together represent just

Corporate champions power country returns

Benchmark returns often move in tandem with the performance of dominant constituents

MSCI Index	Largest constituent	Weight in index (%)	1-year return of stock (%)	1-year index return (%)
Taiwan	Taiwan Semiconductor	54.8	99.8	93.1
Netherlands	ASML Holding NV	50.3	128.7	46.8
Denmark	Novo Nordisk A/S	39.6	-45.3	-24.1
S Korea	Samsung Electronics	33.7	356.6	200.4
Singapore	DBS Group Holdings	28.8	39.0	12.0
Thailand	Delta Electronics Thai	26.8	250.3	43.7
Indonesia	Bank Central Asia	24.3	-41.9	-42.2
Spain	Banco Santander SA	21.8	50.7	31.5
Mexico	Grupo Mexico SAB	17.3	110.0	28.9
Saudi Arabia	Al Rajhi Bank	17.1	7.0	3.7
China	Tencent Holdings	13.4	-11.6	-3.3
South Africa	AngloGold Ashanti	12.5	72.0	24.3
USA	NVIDIA Corp	7.8	43.4	22.4
India	HDFC Bank	6.4	-31.9	-16.0

Source: MSCI index factheets; Index portfolio data as of May 29, 2026. Returns (in % in USD terms) as of June 11, 2026. Bloomberg data

17.5 per cent, among the lowest concentration levels across major markets. By comparison, the corresponding figure exceeds 60 per cent in Taiwan, South Korea, Denmark and the Netherlands.

This broader base also feeds into India's relative appeal for overseas investors. India is the only emerging market that offers political, economic and earnings stability, Ganeshram Jayaraman, CIO & Head of Avendus Public Equities, had said in an earlier interview to *bl.portfolio*. Sector representation is also considerably broader. Financials account for 28.4 per cent of the index, followed by consumer discretionary at 12.1 per cent and industrials at 11.5 per cent. No single sec-

tor comes close to the dominance seen in Taiwan, where information technology accounts for 88.8 per cent of the benchmark, or South Korea, where technology represents more than 70 per cent.

This means that investors buying India are gaining exposure to multiple drivers of economic growth rather than a single corporate or sectoral story.

THE TRADE-OFF Diversification, however, comes with a trade-off. Concentrated markets can generate spectacular returns when their dominant stock or sector is in favour.

But concentration also magnifies risk. Denmark offers a recent reminder. The

MSCI Denmark Index fell 24 per cent over the past year as Novo Nordisk, its largest constituent, declined 45.3 per cent. With nearly 40 per cent of the benchmark tied to a single stock, weakness in one company translated into weakness for the entire market.

The higher the concentration, the more a country index behaves like a single-stock portfolio rather than a diversified representation of an economy.

TAKEAWAY

The distinction between country risk and company risk is increasingly blurred in several global markets. Investors buying Taiwan, South Korea or the Netherlands are often expressing a view on TSMC, Samsung Electronics or ASML as much as they are on the underlying economies. Country ETFs and index funds in such markets can therefore be far less diversified than they appear.

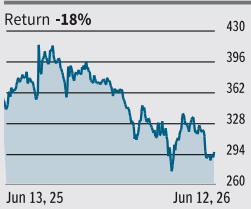
India is not free from concentration risk. Financials remain the largest sector, accounting for more than a quarter of the benchmark. Yet compared with many of its global peers, India's market is far less dependent on the fortunes of any single company or theme.

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

EIH: Accumulate on dips

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Investors with a four/five-year horizon can buy shares of luxury hotel chain EIH on dips, as the sharp correction in the stock has improved the risk-reward.

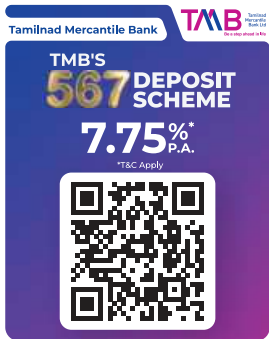


The owner of the Oberoi and Trident hotel brands now trades at about 21 times the FY27 estimated earnings, lower than key listed peers, while its net-cash balance sheet, renovation-led upgrade cycle and visible hotel pipeline support the medium-term story.

The stock has corrected about 32 per cent from its September 2025 high, making valuations less demanding than before.

FY26 earnings were weak despite revenue growth, occupancy trends need monitoring and a large part of the expansion pipeline is back-ended towards 2029-30.

Investors should, therefore, accumulate gradually on market-led declines, keeping in mind risks from mid-cap volatility, capex disruption, softer foreign tourist arrivals and geopolitical tensions.



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SUKHOI SPECTACLE



BLAZING WINGS. A Sukhoi fighter jet of the Indian Air Force releases flares during an aerial display at the Combined Graduation Parade at the Air Force Academy, Dundigal, near Hyderabad on Saturday. RAMAKRISHNA G

As US blocks Anthropic Fable 5, Mythos 5 access to foreign nationals, tech gurus push sovereign AI

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

With the US deciding to block foreign nationals from accessing Anthropic's Fable 5 and Mythos 5, Indian tech thought leaders have flagged concerns about the risks of using AI models developed abroad.

Though there is no direct impact yet, experts have urged Indian organisations and other users to treat this as a wake-up call as they transition to AI-led operations and deploy advanced Large Language Model-based solutions.

The US government on Friday issued an export control order, directing Anthropic to suspend all access to Fable 5 and Mythos 5 by any foreign national, whether inside or outside the country. The list also includes foreign nationals who are working for



the company. This has resulted in the abrupt disablement of the two models for the target customers.

While announcing the abrupt suspension of access to Fable 5 and Mythos 5 models, Anthropic has apologised to its customers. "We believe this is a misunderstanding and are working to restore access as soon as possible," it said.

Though this move has not impacted access to other Claude models, it has triggered a global uproar. Experts said that a possible abrupt suspension of AI services could seriously hurt business operations.

Jaspreet Bindra, Founder of AI and

Beyond, said the development was no surprise. "This was always a possibility. We have already seen this move before, a little bit with Microsoft suspending services to Nayara Energy. AI has emerged as a key utility like IT, water and energy," he said. "This is precisely why we should have our own sovereign AI," he said.

Zoho Chief Scientist Sridhar Vembu highlighted that globalisation is dead and that technology is the ultimate weapon. He asked Indian companies to adopt smaller open-source models from India and China and focus on cost-effective research and development.

Gundala Nagaraju, an AI governance expert and CEO of Astravision NextGen Catalyst, urged organisations to avoid over-reliance on a single AI provider by implementing diversification and resilience strategies.

Srikanth Velamakanni, Chairman of Nasscom, said that models would continue to improve over the next few months. "Managing this AI progress and making sure that AI is used responsibly requires coordinated global efforts. The arrival of Mythos just heightens the urgency around this need for global collaboration," he said.

Hemant Mohapatra, Vice-Chairman of LightSpeed India, said that beyond capital, building a foundational AI model that is competitive from scratch can cost anywhere between \$250 million and \$600 million.

"This is not as much about raising \$50-60 billion, or raising it all at once. The early bottleneck is more on securing top talent and the GPUs," he added.

With inputs from Rohan Das, Chennai

Tata's iPhone parts factory contaminated farmland, wells in Hosur, says TNPCB

Reuters
Bengaluru

A pollution regulator has alleged wastewater discharged from a Tata components factory for Apple's iPhone has contaminated the groundwater for nearby farms and warned of a forced shutdown unless Tata gives a satisfactory explanation.

Tata Electronics is central to Apple's push to diversify iPhone production beyond China and is the second biggest supplier to Apple in South Asia after Taiwan's Foxconn.

The Tata plant under investigation is in Hosur in Tamil Nadu and makes back panels and other components for iPhones. Farmland owners near the plant had complained for months to the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TNPCB)



UNDER THE LENS. The Tata Electronics plant in Hosur, Tamil Nadu, which makes Apple iPhone components

that wastewater from the factory was contaminating their land and open wells.

FIVE INSPECTIONS The complaints led to five State inspections between December 2025 and May 2026, according to details from a previously unreported regulatory notice dated May 25 and reviewed by Reuters.

The inspections found that Tata discharged wastewater into a rainwater harvesting pond inside its facility and that the pond

overflowed to contaminate "groundwater in the open wells located in the adjacent agricultural lands", the Pollution Board's warning notice to Tata said. Tata had not taken any corrective actions on instructions issued by the Board in a previous letter dated December 23, 2025, it said in the three-page notice.

FULLY COMPLIANT: TATA Tata Electronics told Reuters in a statement that it had commissioned an independent analysis through

an accredited laboratory and that the study determined the company was "in full compliance with all regulatory norms".

Tata said it was "committed to responsible business practices and protection of the environment and local communities", and that it had responded to pollution authorities, although giving no further details.

The Pollution Board in its May notice asked Tata to explain why power to the unit should not be cut and the unit closed for its alleged breach of the rules.

Neither Apple, which has strict rules on how its suppliers handle wastewater, nor the Tamil Nadu government responded to requests for comment from Reuters.

India is projected to make 26 per cent of all iPhones globally in 2026, according to research firm Counterpoint.

Start-ups dish up freeze-dried comfort food for travellers

From lemon rice to *rajma chawal*, D2C brands offer a choice of shelf-stable meals

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

School friends Rahul Jain, Pranit Shah and Monish Agarwal had spent months planning a long-overdue reunion in the Swiss Alps. Their itinerary included luxury resorts in B\u00fcrgerstock, Gstaad and St. Moritz, where suites cost thousands of dollars a night. Yet, as the departure date approached, their worry wasn't about flights, hotels or sightseeing. It was food.

For generations, Indians, finicky about onion, garlic and presence of lard, solved that problem by packing *theplas*, home-made mixes and carefully prepared meals before a journey. Now, a small ecosystem of start-ups has commercialised the home-made travel hack. The companies, including Surat-based Bowful Foods, Rohini-based Dryfit in Delhi, and Mumbai's Bombay Tiffin Co.



Freeze-dried products are lighter and can remain shelf-stable for months without preservatives

are betting on freeze-dried technology to create lightweight, shelf-stable meals ranging from *sambhar*, lemon rice and *idli*-based dishes to *rajma chawal* and Jain-friendly gravies.

LIGHTER & EASIER

Unlike the processed ready-to-eat meals sold by companies such as MTR, Haldiram's and ITC, freeze-dried products are lighter, easier to carry and can remain shelf-

stable for months without preservatives.

"We initially saw demand from consumers with very specific dietary requirements, but repeat orders showed the need was much broader," Aayushi Jain, Co-founder of Sonipat-based DryM Foods, told *businessline*.

"Students, professionals and families abroad were all looking for familiar food," she said, describing how the market was bigger than the niche communities they initially targeted.

While established food giants built their businesses through distributors and supermarket shelves, the disruptors are taking a different route.

They sell through Instagram reels, WhatsApp groups, Facebook travel communities and Diaspora networks, where trust often matters more than brand size

and recommendations travel faster than products.

GROWING MARKET

The opportunity is growing. India's freeze-dried food market, estimated at \$109 million in 2025, is projected to reach \$315 million by 2033, aided by rising outbound travel, student migration and a growing Diaspora.

The menus increasingly reflect that ambition. Beyond meals, some brands now sell products such as ready-to-eat *paan*, recognising that for many Indians abroad, the demand extends beyond nutrition to small rituals of home.

The category is also moving beyond online sales. Companies are exploring travel retail, airline catering and institutional channels. DryM has already secured business with IRCTC's premium train services, including Vande Bharat and other trains.

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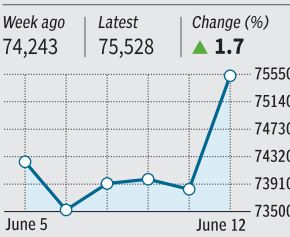
WISE WORDS.

“You need an edge to make money. Do not rely on a combination of hope and good luck.”

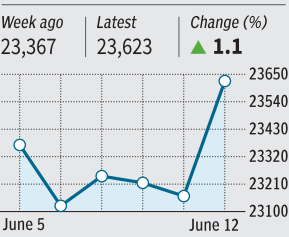
PETER LYNCH
Legendary Fund Manager

MARKET ACTION.

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NIFTY



Your credit scores matter more now

LOAN WISE. With banks moving into the ECL model of providing for bad loans from FY28, there could be implications on your credit scores and loan rates too. Read on to get the bigger picture

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl, research bureau

A paradigm shift is about to take place in banking, come FY28. Banks will move to an expected credit loss (ECL) model of providing for bad loans from the current incurred loss model. The ECL model is adopted globally, and it is the turn of banks in India to follow suit. Simply put, the model is inherently more proactive in recognising credit risk and by virtue of the RBI's regulations, raises the baseline provision coverage significantly.

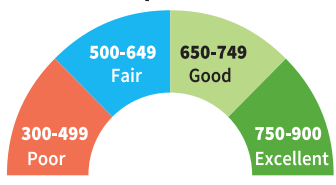
While this will certainly affect banks, it will also influence your borrowing costs — especially if you don't closely monitor and maintain a good credit score.

What is the ECL model? What does it entail? How does it have implications on your credit score? We'll dive into all of this, while also helping readers who are new to credit scores get started on the right foot.

THREE-DIGIT WONDER

Credit scores, or as some call them CIBIL scores, are three-digit numbers between 300 and 900 that measure an individual's creditworthiness. Higher the score, higher the creditworthiness. In other words, higher the score, lower the borrowing cost. Here's why.

Credit core spectrum



Source: HDFC Bank

You see, banks and NBFCs are in the risk business. Their objective is to maximise risk-adjusted returns or make the most money possible for a given level of credit risk (risk that the money lent may not be repaid in full or partially). A higher credit score implies a lower probability of default and so, banks may charge you a lower rate of interest. On the other hand, banks charge higher interest rates for borrowers with lower credit scores, simply because the risk is higher there.

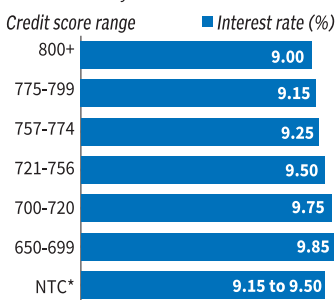
One can segregate the spectrum of credit scores from 300 to 900 into four broad buckets. A score of 750 and above is the top tier and borrowers with such scores get the best deals. Data from CIBIL reveals that 79 per cent of all loans are sanctioned to persons with scores more than 750. Scores from 650 to 749 follow the top tier with rates offered being slightly higher. Scores 500-649 and 300-499 form the bottom most tiers. While rates will be certainly higher and terms less favourable, chances are high that your application will be straight up rejected.

Credit scores are provided by institutions known as CICs or credit information companies. These are licensed by the RBI to collect banking data of individuals for the calculation

How interest rates vary with credit score

SBI Auto loan

Tenor: Above 5 years



Source: SBI

Bank of India Star home loan

Credit score range	Interest rate (%)	
	Salaried	Non-salaried
840+	7.10	7.10
800-839	7.25	7.25
760-799	7.40	7.50
725-759	7.90	8.00
700-724	8.40	8.45
<700	10.00	10.00
NTC*	7.90	7.90

Source: Bank of India *NTC: new to credit

Higher credit scores translate to savings on interest

A and B avail Bank of India's Star home loan. Both are salaried.

	A	B
Loan amount (₹)	1,00,00,000	1,00,00,000
Tenor (years)	20	20
Credit score	820	720
Interest rate (%)	7.25	8.4
Monthly EMI (₹)	79,038	86,150
Difference in EMI (₹)	-	7,112
Total repayment (₹)	1,89,69,120	2,06,76,000
Difference in total repayment (₹)	-	17,06,880

Typically, for home loans floating interest rate is applicable. However, a fixed interest rate is assumed for ease of calculation.

of credit scores. TransUnion CIBIL is the most popular CIC with its 'CIBIL score'. Other CICs include Equifax, Experian and CRIF High Mark.

CICs track multiple financial parameters of an individual to arrive at the credit score but they broadly fit into one of the following — loan enquiries made, loans outstanding, repayment history and credit card history.

ECL MODEL

With that brief out of the way, let us address the elephant in the room.

It is important to regularly monitor the accuracy of your credit data in your credit report. The credit report contains your score, personal information, information on your monthly income and occupation. More importantly, it has details on the loans you have borrowed, loans you have applied for ('credit enquiries'), credit limit sanc-

Starting FY28, banks will shift to the ECL model of making provisions on bad loans. But first, let us look at how things stand currently. As said above, banks follow an incurred loss model now. This model stipulates making provisions on an ex-post basis — meaning, provisions will be made only after the occurrence of a trigger event. Default or non-repayment of dues being the trigger here. However, the model suffers from a flaw. Defaults are just outcomes of credit risk which may be brewing for quite a while. By the time provisions are made, it becomes too late, unless banks themselves are voluntarily proactive.

A quick sidenote: Extant regulations do require banks to provide for standard assets (loans yet to become NPA) too but the quantum is not significant compared with the upcoming ECL framework (we will circle back to this later).

Let's look at an example. Assume Swati has two personal loans - one from Bank A and the other from Bank B. Due to financial difficulties, she defaults on the loan from Bank A but manages to pay dues on the loan from Bank B. Under the current model, as Swati's account hasn't become NPA, Bank B need not create provisions (apart from the baseline provision on standard assets). However, it could only be a matter of time before she defaults on her dues to Bank B.

The ECL model fixes this very flaw. It would require banks to allocate higher provisions whenever there is an event that raises the probability of default risk and not wait until the actual default happens (ex-ante model). This in technical terms is defined as significant increase in credit risk or SICR, and forms the cornerstone of the ECL model.

In the above example, under ECL norms, Bank B would be required to recognise Swati's account to be exhibiting SICR, taking cues from a dip in her credit score.

PROVISIONS GO UP

Provisioning under the ECL model follows a tiered approach. Accounts need to be classified into stages 1, 2 and 3, depending on whether they exhibit any SICR. Higher the stage, higher the provision. Before proceeding to the stages, it helps understanding what could cause SICR. The RBI's Directions contain an illustrative list of drivers of SICR. Key among them are as follows: Changes in credit rating, macroeconomic environment of the borrower, the value of the collateral and any breach of contract that could result in covenant revisions.

How regulatory floors for Stage 2 accounts differ

Category	% of loan outstanding	
	ECL norms	Extant norms equivalent
General/ residual	5.00	0.40
Home loan	1.50	0.25
Secured retail loan	5.00	0.40
Unsecured retail loan	5.00	0.40
Gold loan	1.50	0.40
Farm credit	5.00	0.25
Corporate loan	5.00	0.40
Loans to small & micro enterprises	5.00	0.25
Loans to medium enterprises	5.00	0.40

This is not an exhaustive list of regulatory floors for all loan categories Source: RBI

Stage 1 accounts are those which have not seen any SICR since the beginning. As a baseline, banks need to make provisions on these accounts too, even though there is no default. Provisions need to be based on the next 12-month ECL — meaning, banks will have to look at all possibilities of default over the next 12 months, assign probability weights and appropriately make provisions. Banks can build models based on historical data to make these calculations.

Stage 2 accounts are those which have experienced SICR, but are yet to become Stage 3. Banks need to make provisions based on lifetime ECL — meaning, banks will have to look at all possibilities of default until the end of life of the loan, assign probability weights and create provisions. Assume a credit card holder's credit score drops suddenly. If in the bank's judgment, the account has seen SICR now, it should downgrade the account to Stage 2.

The RBI Directions also suggest that any account that is 30 days past due are to be classified as Stage 2, unless banks can prove otherwise that the account has not seen any SICR.

Stage 3 accounts are those which are considered to be 'credit impaired'. Non-performing assets (NPAs) or accounts that are overdue by over 90 days fall under this category. Just like Stage 2 accounts, provisions are to be based on lifetime ECL. While the classification criterion is in line with extant regulations, the new framework additionally includes cases where a borrower is in financial distress or where there is a high probability of insolvency as 'credit impaired', even before becoming overdue by over 90 days.

While primarily, the quantum of provision is left to the judgment of the

banks based on their models, the RBI has prescribed regulatory floors or minimum mandatory level of provisions. In general, the regulatory floor applicable for Stage 1 accounts is 0.4 per cent of loan outstanding, though for some loan products, a lower/higher ratio has been prescribed. This is largely in line with the extant regulations for standard assets (accounts that are yet to become NPAs).

However, Stage 2 is where things get interesting. The general regulatory floor applicable for Stage 2 accounts is 5 per cent of loan outstanding, significantly higher than the 0.4 per cent prescribed by extant rules. Similarly, there is a bump in the general floor applicable for Stage 3 accounts (equivalent to sub-standard assets or NPAs under extant rules) to 25 per cent of loan outstanding from the 15 per cent per extant norms.

THE IMPLICATIONS

As you would have observed, under the upcoming ECL norms, banks may have to set aside substantially higher provisions, especially for Stage 2 and Stage 3 accounts — and all that differentiates a Stage 1 account from a Stage 2 (and perhaps further to Stage 3) is SICR, which could be due to a simple credit rating/ credit score downgrade. If banks are required to have higher provisions, their ability to put capital to the fullest use is hindered, thus logically leading to higher interest rates for accounts exhibiting SICR or rejection of application in some cases.

This, here, is the core idea of the story — why with ECL norms, you must be more careful about your credit score now than ever. Even inadvertent drops in the score could mean adverse consequences.

CREDIT SCORE MATH

CICs look at four broad factors to compute your credit score. If you score well on these fronts, you can pretty much be assured of a good credit score.

Age of credit: How long your credit track record is. The longer the better. This is why you should think twice before closing one of those old, not-in-use credit cards you might have.

Payment history: How consistently you have paid your EMIs on time.

Credit utilisation: How much of the sanctioned credit you are actually using. This is particularly relevant for credit card users. Utilisation ratio of up to 30 per cent is considered healthy. Besides, it is advisable to have a mix of secured and unsecured loans.

To resolve disputes

tioned, loans overdue and a record of your repayments, among others. It is your responsibility to ensure the accuracy of data contained in the report. Inconsistencies with actual records can be detrimental to your credit score. For instance, a

loan repaid in full could still be reflected as being outstanding. Also look at the enquiries section. It may have details on loans you might not have applied for. CICs generally allow one free download of credit report per year. It is important

to note that checking your own credit score often does not affect it.

Sometimes, the inconsistencies may be due to a time gap — between the actual transaction and when it is reflected in the report. If the difference is not auto-

matically reconciled over time, raise a dispute with the CIC (you will need to sign up on their website). Attach supporting documents if necessary. You will get a response within 30 days, typically. Also give a heads up to the relevant bank/ NBFC for a smooth resolution. In extreme cases, escalate the issue on RBI Ombudsman platform.

Too many unsecured loans or credit cards could take your credit score down.

Credit enquiries: How frequently you apply for loans in a given period of time. Too frequent enquiries could portray you as a credit-hungry person, affecting your score.

Besides CICs also look at other ratios.

IMPORTANCE FOR NTCs

Having a weak credit score and hence high borrowing rates is one thing, having no credit history at all and therefore high borrowing rates is another. People falling under the latter category are referred to as 'new to credit' or NTCs. These are persons who wouldn't have borrowed from a bank or NBFC in their lifetime and won't have credit scores. When they eventually apply for a loan, banks might have no idea about their financial hygiene (which the credit score captures) and might end up charging them more. Here's an example. Bank of India charges 7.1 per cent for a housing loan applicant with a credit score of 840 and above, while it charges 7.9 per cent for an NTC applicant. This is equivalent to the rate offered for an applicant with a score between 725 and 759 (see table).

As said above, building a good credit score takes time and lenders prefer a longer credit history. So, if you have plans to take a loan in the future, a housing loan, for instance, it is a good idea to get a credit card, preferably one secured by a fixed deposit, to start building your credit score. If you do so, ensure you pay the entire bill amount (not just the minimum due) on time. You can also choose a card that offers good reward points (to offset annual charges perhaps) or a co-branded card depending on your lifestyle.

TO RECOVER FROM A BAD SCORE

Sometimes, it could so happen that due to circumstances, one may be pushed deep into debt due to layoffs, irrecoverable business losses, among others. Credit score in such cases could have taken a beating. In such cases, following these steps can help.

- Be consistent with paying EMIs on time to the maximum extent possible.
- Pay off loans one after another. If you have many credit cards and personal loan accounts, consolidate them and take a single loan. It will help you do away with multiple due dates.
- Convert some unsecured loans into secured loans like jewel loans, if possible. Reducing excess exposure to unsecured borrowings can help boost your credit score.
- Work towards reducing your existing EMIs to 30 per cent or lower of monthly income.
- Think twice before applying for additional credit.
- Monitor your credit report/ score every six months. You can do it for free on CIC websites. Inadvertent inaccuracies (EMI paid not reflected, for instance) may prevent you from improving your score.
- Rebuilding the credit score will take time. Prepare mentally.

Stocks turn cold in hot summer

SEASONAL EFFECT. Unlike 2025, companies say demand revived from mid-April this year, but a majority of stocks fell despite positive management commentary

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Last year, summer stocks cooled because Summer itself failed to arrive on time. Unseasonal rain-fall, and early weather disruptions spoiled the usually ‘hot’ demand window for air-conditioners, fans, coolers, cold drinks and amusement parks. While there has been broader market volatility this year due to the war in West Asia, last year too, there was volatility due to Operation Sindoor. But looking at the broad divergence within the Summer stocks analysed, there are winners and losers.

Summer indeed picked up clearly after April 13, 2026, across India. As the last of the cool Western Disturbances faded, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) noted that unbroken sunshine and clear skies pushed temperatures in central, north and peninsular regions into the low 40s. The heat has returned, at least according to many management commentaries.

For the uninitiated, Summer is critical because it creates a heavy seasonal concentration of revenue for some firms, where peak volumes during Q1 (April-June) drive full-year performance. In some cases, this quarter accounts for 30-40 per cent of annual turnover.

This year, several companies say demand picked up from mid-April. Some have spoken of heat-waves, strong off-take, better trade pull and a weak base from last year. Yet, a large majority of Summer-linked stocks have again gone cold.

STOCK SHOW

In the roughly two-month period — April 13 to June 12 period this year, the 18-member Summer stock basket fell about 2 per cent on an average, which is not bad given the volatility in markets. But the dispersion within this club has been wide (see table). Out of the 18 stocks analysed, 61 per cent or 11 names reported declines in this period. Benchmarks such as Nifty

Heat plays turn mixed

Name	Sector	Apr-Jun quarter net sales as % of full year sales	(% stock price change) Summer period 2025#	Summer period 2026 *
Aditya Vision	Retail	35	-10.9	6.6
Amber Enterprises	Consumer Durables	28	-1.0	3.4
Blue Star	Consumer Durables	24	-16.4	-8.5
Dabur India	FMCG	26	1.1	0.4
Dixon Technologies	Consumer Durables	26	0.1	9.9
Electronics Mart	Retail	24	9.5	5.0
Emami	FMCG	24	-5.9	-7.8
Epac Durable	Consumer Durables	35	-8.1	-4.4
Havells India	Consumer Durables	24	0.5	-9.4
Orient Electric	Consumer Durables	23	6.1	5.3
Som Distilleries	Alcoholic Beverages	43	30.3	-3.4
Symphony	Consumer Durables	22	0.2	-9.8
United Breweries	Alcoholic Beverages	31	1.3	-7.4
Varun Beverages	FMCG	32	-13.9	21.3
V-Guard Industries	Capital Goods - Electrical Equipment	25	3.7	-4.7
Voltas	Consumer Durables	28	-0.6	-5.6
Whirlpool India	Consumer Durables	30	20.1	-6.3
Wonderla Holidays	Entertainment	32	-5.9	-11.3

Net sales are consolidated FY2026 figures, except for Wonderla, Aditya Vision and Orient Electric. For Varun Beverages, which follows a December year-end, consolidated CY2025 sales have been used. #April 11-June 13, 2025 *April 13-June 12, 2026 Sector name as per Capitaline

FMCG and Nifty Consumption are up 2.6 per cent and 1.3 per cent respectively in the same period. The broader market benchmark Nifty 50 has corrected 0.9 per cent in this period.

The worst of the market heat was felt by those connected to cooling, appliance and amusement park names. Shares of Wonderla Holidays fell 11.3 per cent, Havells India and Symphony dipped over 9 per cent each and Blue Star inched down 8.5 per cent. Epac Durable, which specialises in design and manufacturing of large domestic appliances such as ACs and coolers, fell 4.4 per cent. Voltage stabiliser maker V-Guard Industries, an essential derivative play on all white goods sales, slipped 4.7 per cent, as did Whirlpool of India (down 6.3 per cent) and Voltas (down 5.6 per cent).

The pain was also seen in some discretionary plays. FMCG major Emami fell around 7.8 per cent, and United Breweries tanked 7.4 per cent.

That split is important. Because this was not a straight sell-off in everything linked to Summer. Varun Beverages gained over 21 per cent and Dixon Technologies gained around 10 per cent.

The contrast with 2025 lies in the commentary. Last year, companies were clearly battling a delayed Summer. This year, many managements sound more hopeful as per their latest Q4FY26 con-calls. Amber Enterprises said heat was already very high in the North and demand was good. Against a weak base last year, it said the room AC industry expected around 20 per cent growth in Q1. It also said that after April 12, positive off-take was seen because of heatwaves in the South, West and North.

Blue Star described the ongoing period as a great Summer season, though not like 2024. But its commentary also captured the market's worry. The company said it needed another eight weeks of Summer to manage huge inventory in the trade and inventory



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

build-up.

Epac Durable, too, had built inventory in anticipation of a strong Summer. It said April onwards, especially from mid-April, tailwinds had been very strong and inventory pain of the past 12 months had eased. Symphony said channel caution lasted until March 31 because of inventory overhang and the bad Summer of 2025, but South, West and parts of Central India saw decent April performance. Voltas said April and May had shown positive traction due to heatwaves, though intermittent rains continued in some regions.

The beverages side appears warmer. Varun Beverages said Summer looked very good, trends were positive and consumption was strong compared with last year's terrible rain-hit base. It cited strong growth in dairy, Nim-booz, Tropicana PET and energy drinks. That fits the stock's positive performance.

Dabur management noted that while a severe El Niño Summer

AT A GLANCE

- Demand revived, yet many Summer plays cooled
- Warmer commentary did not protect some pricey stocks
- Earnings must prove every seasonal story

would drive double-digit growth in beverages and glucose, they are seeing unseasonal thunderstorms on the ground in key North Indian markets. However, even if an acute Summer fails to materialise, a low base ensures the company will still perform better than last year.

But Emami shows why the weather trade remains risky. The company said Q4FY26 was hit by the delayed Summer, inconsistent temperatures and unseasonal rainfall. Its Summer portfolio declined 22 per cent, with talcum

powders alone falling 40 per cent. Voltas also explained that commercial refrigeration, including deep freezers and visi coolers, is directly linked to heat intensity because ice-cream and beverage demand drives buying. In contrast, commercial air-conditioning is a B2B business and not linked in the same way to Summer intensity.

VALUATIONS MATTER

So, why did a whole host of stocks cool despite warmer commentary? Valuations may be the answer. Bloomberg-derived estimates show that FY26 remains weak or uneven for many of these names, while FY27 assumes a strong rebound. Across 18 companies, average FY26 revenue growth year on year is just about 4.3 per cent. FY26-adjusted net profit growth is a mere 6.2 per cent, slower than the 8.1 per cent for FY25. Yet, average FY26 Price to Earnings (P/E) is about 53.4 times.

FY27 looks better mainly on

the revenue line. Average revenue growth is estimated at about 18.7 per cent, but average profit growth is projected at about 7.4 per cent, only 1.2 percentage points higher than FY26. That means the market is not just betting on a hotter season; it is also expecting better operating leverage, inventory clearance and margin protection.

But that is exactly the point. The recovery is already priced in for many counters. Voltas trades at 93.2x FY26 P/E (FY27 P/E 52.4x), Amber at 91.7x (60.8x), Dixon at 73.6x (64.1x), Blue Star at 60.4x (47.9x) and Aditya Vision at 58.5x (43.5x). Many stocks are not cheap versus own history.

So, the weather has turned hot, companies are talking up demand, but the market is asking a tougher question: Will a few strong weeks be enough to clear inventory, protect margins and justify peak-summer valuations? For investors, the lesson is unchanged. Seasonality can sell a story. Earnings have to prove it.

L Ashwin Ramakrishnan

Factor investing offers an increasingly important framework for equity allocation, driven by distinct drivers of returns.

Rather than tracking the market passively, factor indices tilt towards characteristics (such as low volatility, momentum, value and quality), each of which behaves differently across market cycles.

The BSE Low Volatility Index, for instance, tracks the 30 least volatile stocks within the BSE LargeMidCap universe, selecting and weighting them based on historical price variability. This results in a portfolio tilted towards relatively-stable, cash-generative businesses across sectors such as financials, consumer and healthcare. Current key constituents include Reliance Industries, HDFC Bank, Bharti Airtel, ICICI Bank, SBI and TCS.

Momentum strategies target stocks exhibiting sustained price strength, value focuses on relatively-inexpensive stocks based on fundamentals, and quality emphasises profitability and balance sheet strength. Together, these approaches illustrate that equity returns can be accessed through multiple, distinct pathways.

DISPERSION IN OUTCOMES

Over longer timeframes, factor strategies in India have showed meaningful dispersion in outcomes. Despite its defensive construction, the Low Volatility Index has delivered superior returns when compared with headline equity indices over long holding periods.

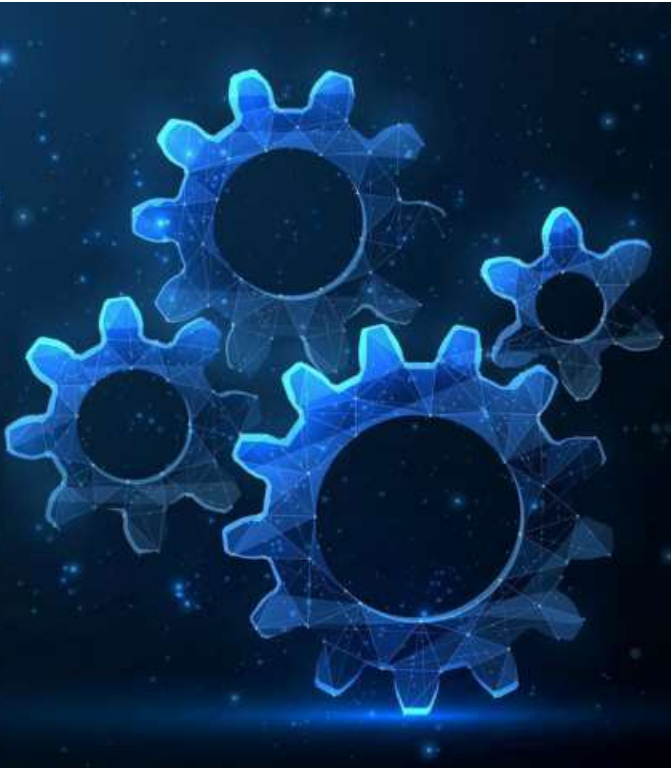
Momentum and value, though, have been able to achieve significantly better absolute returns. This divergence is a result of the underlying drivers of each factor. Momentum benefits from persistent market trends and tends to perform well in directional markets. Value gains during cyclical recoveries and re-rating phases, while quality and low volatility prioritise volatility and consistency over aggressive outperformance.

THE REAL DIFFERENTIATOR

Where factors differ more clearly is in their risk profiles. Low volatility stands out for its conservative characteristics, exhibiting lower variability than

Decoding factor-based strategies

THEIR VIEW. Rather than tracking the market passively, factor indices tilt towards characteristics which behave differently across market cycles



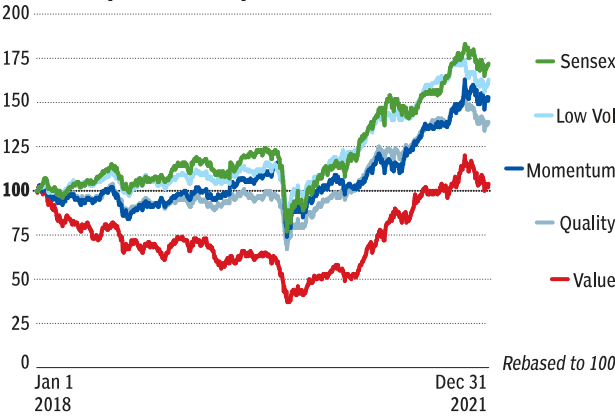
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How factor indices fare across risk, reward metrics

	Sensex	Low vol	Momentum	Quality	Value
10-year CAGR (%)	11.0	11.6	16.0	15.5	12.4
Mean 3-year rolling returns (%)	13.3	13.5	17.2	17.0	13.8
Sharpe's ratio (x)	0.37	0.47	0.57	0.49	0.47
Beta (x)	1.00	0.67	0.95	1.07	0.75
Annualised volatility (%)	16.3	12.9	19.2	23.6	15.0
Max drawdown (%)	38.1	28.9	35.8	63.7	35.1
Downcapture ratio (x)	1.0	0.7	0.9	1.1	0.8

Data as of March 30

Pre- and post-Covid performance



the market and tending to participate less in draw-downs. This makes it comparable, in some respects, to conservative large-cap investing, but with a more explicit focus on risk control.

Despite investing in stocks trading at cheaper valuations, Value represents the most ag-

gressive end of the spectrum. While it has historically generated high returns over full cycles, it has also been associated with higher volatility and deeper pullbacks, reflecting its cyclical nature.

A useful illustration of how these differences play out is the

● TAKE NOTE

Over longer timeframes, factor strategies in India have showed meaningful dispersion in outcomes

Covid-led crash in 2020. During this period, the Sensex experienced a draw-down of roughly 38 per cent, while low-volatility strategies declined materially less, by around 30 per cent. This was consistent with their lower downside capture (around 0.7). Value strategies were the most impacted, with materially-deeper draw-downs of over 60 per cent, before rebounding strongly in the subsequent recovery phase.

The episode highlights how factor behaviour can diverge sharply during stress events, underlining the role of diversification across factors.

RISK-ADJUSTED OUTCOMES

When returns are viewed alongside risk, the trade-offs become clearer. Momentum has combined strong returns with favourable efficiency metrics. Low volatility and quality, while delivering moderate returns, have done so with better downside control, resulting in competitive risk-adjusted outcomes.

The growing availability of

factor-based index funds and ETFs has made it easier for investors to access these strategies.

Products, today, span individual factors as well as blended approaches that combine multiple styles. Rather than viewing any one factor as universally suitable, a combination of factors can help create more resilient portfolios across market cycles.

An extension of this approach is the rise of multi-factor strategies, which combine two or more factors.

The rationale is straightforward: Since factor performance tends to rotate across market cycles, blending them can help smooth return outcomes and reduce dependence on any one factor. For instance, the defensive characteristics of low volatility and quality can help cushion draw-downs, while momentum and value can contribute to return enhancement during trending or recovery phases.

While multi-factor strategies may not outperform the best-performing single factor at any point in time, they aim to deliver more consistent performance across varying market environments, making them a practical approach for diversified equity exposure.

The author is a SEBI registered investment advisor. The views are the author's and does not reflect the opinion of bl.portfolio

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

		Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
Small Savings Scheme		Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5*	7.5*	Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026. #Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

ALERTS.

IOB hikes rates for select non-callable FDs

Indian Overseas Bank (IOB) has announced an upward revision in interest rates for its domestic non-callable fixed deposits. The decision was finalised during the bank's recent Asset-Liability Committee (ALCO) meeting. Following the ALCO directive, the bank has implemented a 10 basis points (0.10 per cent) interest rate hike across three specific time-frames.

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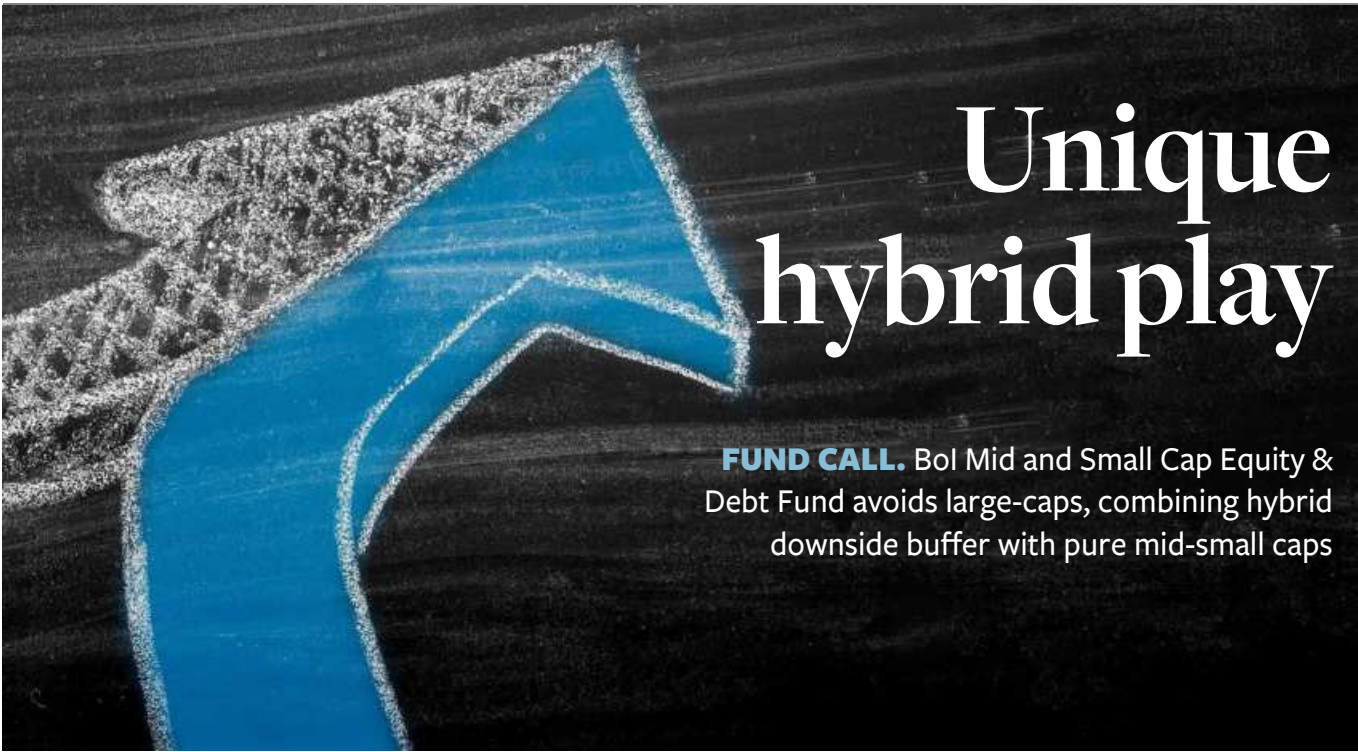


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Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Aggressive hybrid funds can be a useful mutual fund category for investors seeking equity-like growth with some downside protection. These funds invest 65-80 per cent of their portfolios in equities, with the balance allocated to debt instruments.

However, aggressive hybrid funds are far from uniform. Differences in asset allocation, market-cap preferences and portfolio management styles can lead to significant variations in risk and return. For instance, PGIM India Aggressive Hybrid has stayed near the lower end of the equity range, averaging about 66 per cent in equities over the last five years, whereas Aditya Birla SL Equity Hybrid ‘95 has maintained over 75 per cent equity exposure. Shriram Aggressive Hybrid Fund and Navi Aggressive Hybrid Fund follow a more dynamic approach within the permitted range.

Market-cap preferences vary just as widely. ICICI Prudential Equity & Debt and Quant Aggressive Hybrid lean heavily towards large-caps, while HSBC Aggressive Hybrid Fund and JM Aggressive Hybrid Fund maintain a mix across market capitalisations.

Standing entirely apart is Bank of India Mid & Small Cap Equity & Debt Fund (BEDF). It is the only fund in the category that completely avoids large-cap stocks, investing its entire equity portfolio in mid- and small-cap companies. This makes BEDF a distinct proposition, offering the downside buffer of a hybrid structure alongside the high-growth, high-volatility characteristics of a pure mid- and small-cap strategy.

Its mid- and small-cap focus has delivered. The fund has compounded at 15 per cent an-



WHY INVEST

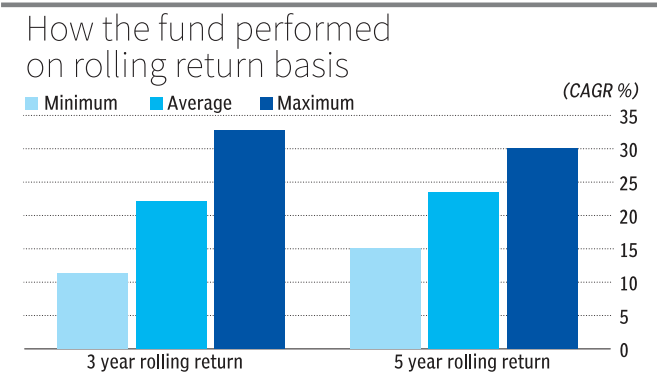
- Pure mid- and small-cap equity portfolio
- High-credit-quality debt allocation
- Suitable for investors seeking high-growth exposure with lower volatility than pure mid- or small-cap funds

nually since its launch in July 2016. However, with no large-cap anchor, it tends to be more volatile than most hybrid peers during market downturns. It is, therefore, suited to investors with a high risk appetite and a long investment horizon, rather than those seeking stability from a hybrid allocation.

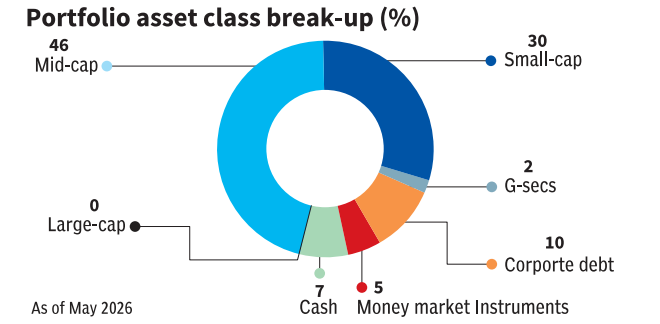
MID- AND SMALL-CAP ORIENTATION

Over the past five years, the fund has typically maintained 70-78 per cent of its portfolio in equities, with the remainder invested in debt instruments. A defining feature of the equity portfolio is its strict adherence to the fund’s mandate. Stocks that graduate to the large-cap universe are exited, ensuring the portfolio remains focused on the mid- and small-cap segments.

The fund increased its mid-cap exposure from 40 per cent to 46 per cent (as of May 2026) of



The chart illustrates the fund’s performance based on 3-year and 5-year rolling returns calculated from the last 7 year NAV history, highlighting the minimum, average, and maximum returns achieved over these periods. Source: ACEMF Value as of June 11, 2026



the total assets over the past year, as the fund manager found valuations in the segment more attractive.

On an average, the fund has allocated about 45 per cent to mid-caps and 31 per cent to small-caps over the last five years. It applies strict quality filters in small-cap selection, avoiding companies with a market capitalisation below ₹1,000 crore and favouring businesses with sound fundamentals. To manage liquidity risk, it ensures that 80 per cent of the portfolio can be liquidated within six working days and limits exposure to individual small-cap stocks to 3 per cent.

EQUITY PHILOSOPHY

The fund follows a change-driven investment approach, seeking businesses benefiting from company-specific, in-

dustry, policy or economic developments. Before investing, it evaluates the sustainability of the change and conducts rigorous checks on management quality, corporate governance standards and business fundamentals.

Key parameters in stock selection include return on equity, cash-flow strength, business sustainability and competitive advantages. Over the past two years, the portfolio has been tilted towards domestic themes, in line with government-led capital expenditure. It is overweight on capital goods, metals, power and healthcare, while maintaining a neutral stance on banks. The fund is underweight on IT and oil & gas, reflecting concerns over global uncertainties.

As of the latest portfolio disclosure, the top three sectors

were pharmaceuticals (10.4 per cent), electrical equipment (6.7 per cent) and ferrous metals (5.7 per cent). Over the past year, the fund increased allocations to pharmaceuticals, electrical equipment and insurance by 3-5 percentage points, while completely exiting IT and trimming exposure to ferrous metals and capital markets.

DEBT STRATEGY

The fund’s debt portfolio is managed with a clear focus on risk control. Overseen by Alok Singh, who manages both the equity and debt components, the fund predominantly invests in short-maturity, high-credit-quality instruments, favouring AAA- and AA+-rated securities.

Rather than serving as a return driver, the debt allocation acts as a stabilising buffer, helping contain volatility arising from the mid- and small-cap portfolio. As of May 2026, around 2 per cent of the portfolio was invested in government securities and 13 per cent in AAA-rated papers. Less than 1 per cent was allocated to AA-rated bonds issued by Vedanta, Nuvoco Vistas, Birla Corporation and 360 One Prime.

PERFORMANCE

The fund has participated well in market upcycles, generating strong gains during rallies such as those seen in 2021 and 2024. However, its higher exposure to mid- and small-cap stocks has also made it more vulnerable during market corrections, leading to underperformance in phases such as the September 2024-March 2025 decline.

Even so, its long-term track record remains impressive. Average five-year rolling returns stand at 23 per cent, comfortably ahead of the category average of 16 per cent. These returns have ranged between 15 per cent and 30 per cent. The fund has also outperformed on three-year rolling returns, delivering a CAGR of 22 per cent compared with the category average of 15 per cent.

The expense ratio of the regular plan is 1.82 per cent, marginally lower than the category average of 1.9 per cent. The direct plan is cheaper at 0.69 per cent, compared with the category average of 0.81 per cent.

The fund’s strategy can generate significant upside during favourable market conditions, but its concentrated exposure to mid- and small-cap stocks makes it unsuitable for conservative investors. For those seeking exposure to the higher-growth segments of the market without taking on the full volatility of a pure mid- or small-cap fund, however, it offers a balanced alternative. Investors may consider investing through a systematic investment plan and maintain an investment horizon of at least five years.

Manic impulsiveness fuels SpaceX IPO frenzy

GLOBAL VIEW. Over 20 SpaceX-linked ETFs have been filed, ranging from leveraged & inverse products to options strategies

Bloomberg

Wall Street just spent the week ricocheting between the macro and the mania.

Investors digested mixed inflation data, positive developments in the West Asia conflict and sharp moves in oil prices. At the same time, a scramble for SpaceX exposure spilled far beyond the company’s stock sale, as investors sought alternative ways to participate in one of the most anticipated public debuts in years.

The result was a market struggling to settle on a single narrative, with investors lurching between macroeconomic developments and speculative trades. By one measure, the Nasdaq 100 this week posted its largest average intraday swings since April 2025.

SpaceX became the week’s flashpoint. Retail investors submitted more than \$100 billion in orders for the offering, overwhelming allocations available through brokerages. But unlike past IPO frenzies, demand did not stop at the traditional orderbook. Investors unable to secure shares have been looking for exposure elsewhere. That helped drive big pre-IPO inflows into funds including the \$2-billion Baron First Principles ETF, while fueling activity across a growing network of alternative trading venues.

ETFs GALORE

Polymarket has generated more than \$25 million of volume across SpaceX-related contracts. The activity also spilled

into crypto-native markets, with investors trading perpetual futures linked to the company on the decentralised platform Hyperliquid. What once would have been a straightforward IPO story increasingly played out across multiple trading venues simultaneously.

“That we are seeing a proliferation in ETFs that tie to crowd-favourite stocks speaks to momentum,” said Peter Atwater, President of advisory firm Financial Insights. “The crowd is now speculating on its own manic impulsiveness with the most potency it can find.”

More than 20 SpaceX-linked ETFs have already been filed, ranging from leveraged and inverse products to options-based strategies. A leveraged ETF tied to SpaceX surged more than 80 per cent before grinding to a halt Friday, according to data compiled by Bloomberg and information posted on the Cboe exchange’s website, citing regulatory concern. ETF issuers that once waited months after an IPO to launch related products are now racing to file almost immediately, underscoring the speed with which Wall Street moves to package speculative demand.

“There is room for speculating for sure, but I would rather investors invest,” said Nancy Tengler, CEO at Laffer Tengler Investments, who has a long-term conviction in the company.

The products used to express speculative views are becoming large enough to influence trading in the broader market. Strategists at Nomura estimate leveraged ETFs more broadly now generate roughly \$8 billion



REUTERS

HIGH DEMAND

ETF issuers that once waited months after an IPO to launch related products are now racing to file almost immediately

can both move faster than investors expect,” said Chris Murphy, co-head of derivatives strategy at Susquehanna International Group.

MARKET SWINGS

The week’s swings reflected how quickly the market’s focus changed. A relatively-tame consumer inflation data initially boosted risk assets. A day later, stronger producer-price data raised fresh questions on cost pressures. Meanwhile, comments from President Donald Trump on Iran repeatedly shifted expectations for the conflict and sent oil and equities in opposite directions. By Friday, hopes for a diplomatic breakthrough had helped lift stocks again.

“The on-again, off-again peace deal is driving sharp near-term moves at the index level, making it more challenging to analyse and invest at the single-stock level,” said Michael O’Rourke, Chief Market

ALERTS.

ICICI Pru Nifty Smallcap 250 ETF

ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has announced the launch of the ICICI Prudential Nifty Smallcap 250 ETF, an Exchange Traded Fund that aims to replicate the performance of the Nifty Smallcap 250 Index, subject to tracking error. The Nifty Smallcap 250 Index represents companies ranked between 251 and 500 by market capitalisation within the Nifty 500 universe. The underlying index provides coverage across nearly 20 sectors, including Financial Services, Healthcare, Information Technology, Capital Goods and Automotive components. The NFO period closes June 16. Minimum application amount during NFO is ₹1,000. Fund Managers are Nishit Patel, Ashwini Bharucha and Venus Ahuja.

Global investing platform via GIFT City

SAMCO Securities has announced the launch of its global investing offering, following the grant of a broker-dealer licence by the International Financial Services Centres Authority from GIFT City. This approval will enable Indian investors to invest in US-listed stocks and ETFs through SAMCO Trading App of SAMCO Securities, a regulated, research-backed platform powered through GIFT City. SAMCO Securities’ solution integrates quantitative research, investment recommendations, target prices, stop-loss frameworks and portfolio monitoring. The platform provides research coverage on more than 700 global securities, including constituents of the S&P 500, NASDAQ 100 and over 100 ETFs.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

ETF	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
	as on Jun 12			
ETF				
Tata Nifty Pvt Bank ETF	285.4	285.5	5.3	8
HDFC Nifty Pvt Bank ETF	28.1	28.1	5.2	1,556
Groww Nifty Pvt Bank ETF	27.6	27.7	5.1	260
ICICI Pru Nifty Pvt Bank ETF	27.8	27.9	5.1	30,166
DSP Nifty Pvt Bank ETF	28.0	27.9	4.8	459
MOSL BSE Top 10 Banks ETF	16.8	16.8	4.6	98
SBI Pvt Bank ETF	281.3	280.9	4.6	30
GOLD ETFs				
Invesco India Gold ETF	127.7	128.6	-4.2	107
Axis Gold ETF	122.4	123.2	-4.2	21,662
Baroda BNP Paribas Gold ETF	142.2	143.4	-4.3	306

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on June 12, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Jun 12	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	52.6	11.6	11.0	13.2	76,649
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.6	13.0	11.9	13.1	28,647
Kotak Pension Fund	65.6	12.1	11.6	12.9	4,510
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	31.0	6.4	5.9	8.4	8,797
SBI Pension Fund	41.4	6.5	5.9	7.8	29,192
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	38.2	6.3	5.8	7.7	21,877
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.5	7.8	6.8	8.3	34,250
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.9	7.6	6.5	8.1	13,612
SBI Pension Fund	46.1	7.7	6.5	8.0	15,405
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	45.5	11.7	11.0	13.3	1,820
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	57.3	12.8	11.9	13.1	796
Kotak Pension Fund	57.7	12.1	11.6	12.8	219

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on June 12, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	352	10.2	23.8	23.9
ICICI Pru	Largecap	853	3.1	19.5	16.0
Nippon Life India	Absolute Freedom	NA	3.2	15.5	13.5
Ksema Wealth	Alpha	15	-2.0	14.2	13.4
MULTI CAP					
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	7,681	15.3	39.1	25.9
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	NA	4.1	26.0	24.2
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	114	0.6	26.3	23.5
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,096	10.5	24.6	22.0
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	2.2	21.1	21.9
Negen Capital	Special Situ. & Technology	1,385	-0.4	24.6	21.1
MID-CAP					
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	35.1	24.6	18.0
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	5.6	16.6	17.0
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	5.8	18.3	15.9
Eureka PMS	Signature Approach	NA	2.3	20.1	15.9
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	3,463	41.1	41.1	38.2
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	942	-3.1	22.6	32.6
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	231	11.0	23.5	31.6
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,334	-6.9	27.2	21.8

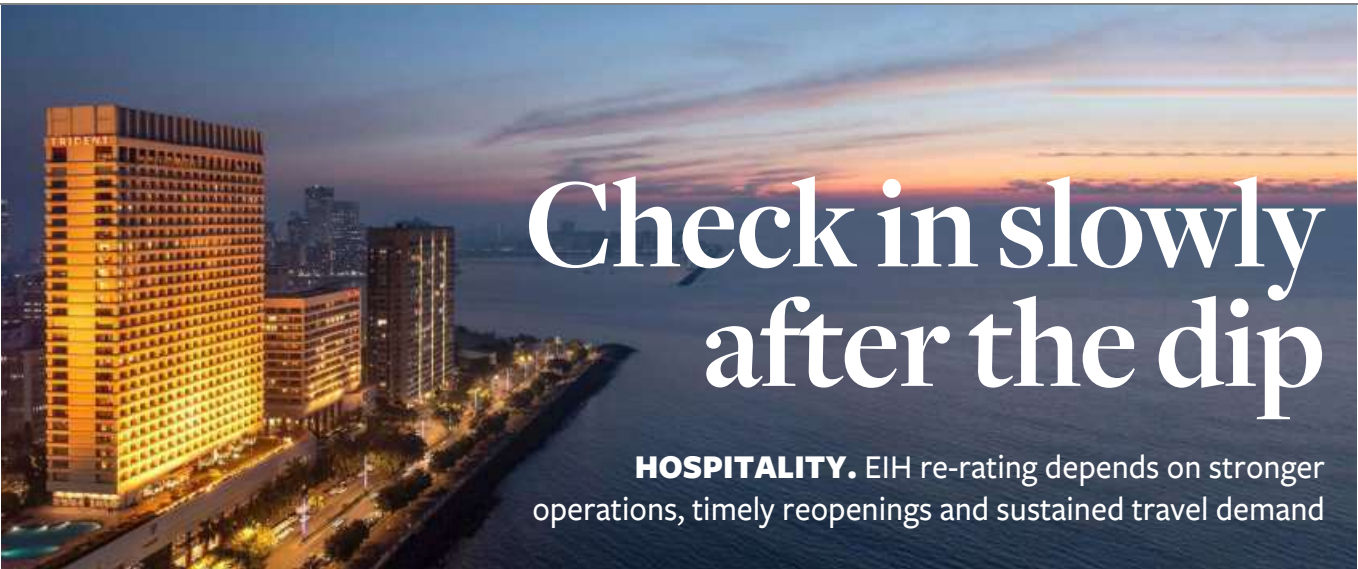
*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on May 31, 2026

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

In June-end of CY25, when shares of luxury hotel chain EIH were trading at ₹359, we had recommended that investors book profits when stock was trading at a one-year forward PE of 31 times. The stock has corrected to around ₹296 since then, which is a fall of 17.5 per cent versus 10.1 per cent dip for the broader market. In fact, the fall from its 52-week high of ₹434 hit in September 2025 is around 32 per cent so far. Following this performance and changing fundamentals, we now believe the stock now deserves a relook.

EIH is no longer a relatively-expensive luxury hotel stock with weak near-term earnings visibility. Valuations have cooled to 21x Price to Earnings (P/E) based on FY27 estimates, which is at an attractive discount to 43x for sector leader Indian Hotels (accumulate on dips), 32x for ITC Hotels (accumulate on dips) and 29x for luxury peer Leela Palaces Hotels & Resorts, formerly Schloss Bangalore (avoid rating for IPO). As per Bloomberg consensus estimates, FY27-28 earnings estimates show decent recovery with earnings CAGR at 18.1 per cent, and the company has given better visibility on its expansion and renovation plans. Thus, investors can accumulate the stock on dips with a four-five year horizon. This is not a plain 'buy' because the operating recovery is still uneven. EIH is a small-cap hospitality stock with a market capitalisation of about ₹18,500 crore. If broader markets remain weak, small-caps correct further, or global tensions hurt foreign tourist arrivals, the stock can still drift lower. West Asia-related uncertainty has already affected foreign tourist arrivals.

BUSINESS
EIH is the owner and operator of the Oberoi and Trident hotel brands. The 30-hotel room portfolio of 4,209, including 408 international keys (March 31, 2026), is smaller than some listed peers, but it sits higher on the luxury curve. The company's domestic hotels continue to command strong positioning in their markets. The management has indicated that most of its hotels rank first or second in their competitive set.



Financial performance (in ₹ cr)					
Parameter	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26
Revenue	985	2,019	2,511	2,743	2,940
EBITDA	2	599	934	1,067	1,135
Net profit	-123	326	644	767	706
Total debt	475	238	199	265	252
Cash & equivalents	316	527	744	1,051	1,113
Capex	66	136	222	484	693
Free cash flow	-73	490	541	425	391

All numbers are adjusted, rounded off and on consolidated basis Source: Bloomberg

This is important because it gives EIH the ability to protect rates. In Q4FY26, Revenue Per Available Room or RevPAR (average revenue generated per available room, regardless of whether it is occupied) grew 7.6 per cent to ₹20,758 per day, even though occupancy fell 400 basis points (bps) to 78 per cent. This shows the strength and the risk of the current cycle. EIH can push rates. But the occupancy cushion is not unlimited.

The luxury hotel cycle is still favourable. Per HVS Anarock, supply in the luxury hospitality sector in India is expected to grow at a CAGR of 5.9 per cent over FY24-28, while demand is expected to grow at a CAGR of 10.6 per cent. Domestic travel demand remains strong. The management also believes Indian luxury hotel rates are still low versus global benchmarks in Europe, North America and parts of Asia.

The balance sheet is another strength. EIH is net-debt free and remains cash-rich with net cash of ₹860 crore (4.65 per cent of m-cap).

This is useful at a time when the company is spending on renovations and expansion. Hospitality assets require constant upkeep.

WHAT HAS CHANGED
Firstly, one of the most important changes is the stock price. At ₹359 in June 2025, the prevailing valuation at that time (31x forward P/E) offered little room for disappointment. That was the main reason to book profits. The company was strong, but the earnings growth was not likely to match the stock's optimism. That has played out. FY26 was not a bad year operationally, but earnings momentum was poor (see chart).

The correction has made valuation reasonable. Based on Bloomberg estimates, the stock trades at about 21 times FY27 earnings and around 18.5 times FY28 earnings. That is not demanding for a net-debt-free luxury hospitality business.

The second change is pipeline visibility. EIH now has a development pipeline of 31 hotels with about 2,700 keys (64 per cent addition from current level). This includes seven owned hotels with 825 keys and 24 managed hotels with 1,893 keys. The owned pipeline includes Visakhapatnam in 2027, Goa and London in 2028, Tirupati in 2029, and Gandikota and Hebbal in 2030.

The managed pipeline is even

● ACCUMULATE ON DIPS
EIH ₹295.70
WHY
● Valuation correction has improved risk-reward
● Pipeline boosts medium-term earnings visibility
● Balance sheet supports capex-led growth phase

larger, but it is heavily back-ended. A major part of the managed additions comes in CY29 and CY30. The company's room-led growth will also take time. For the next two years, the main driver is room rate growth, renovation-led repricing and better cost control.

Renovations are the third change. The Oberoi Grand in Kolkata, The Oberoi Bengaluru, Trident Nariman Point, The Oberoi Mumbai and Trident BKC are all part of the asset upgrade cycle.

These projects can cause near-term disruption, but they can also raise the room rate ceiling once completed. The Oberoi Grand is expected to partly reopen with 50 keys by September 2026. The management expects a fast ramp-up.

Fourthly, EIH now appears decently placed in terms of immediate two-year growth going by Bloomberg estimates. It is expected to deliver two-year adjusted EPS growth of 18.1 per cent CAGR versus 31.6 per cent for Indian Hotels and 17.5 per cent for ITC Hotels.

WHAT CAN GET BETTER
EIH's next leg of re-rating needs better operating leverage. Room rates growth alone is not enough if expenses rise faster. FY26 showed this clearly.

Cost inflation, staff costs, other expenses and higher levies in some businesses (like Oberoi Flight Services) hurt margins.

The company has spoken about cost optimisation and waste reduction. Investors need to monitor this and see if it actually shows up in margins.

Occupancy also needs monitoring. A increase in room revenue with a 400-bp occupancy decline is acceptable if RevPAR keeps growing.

We have seen Leela Palaces report 580-bp occupancy drop in Q4FY26, partly due to West Asia conflict impact.

While luxury hotels can hold rates better than mass-market hotels, they are not immune to macro shocks.

The timing of the pipeline is another key variable. The long-term plan is attractive, but the bulk of additions is closer to 2029 and 2030. Till then, investors must rely on existing assets, renovations and rate hikes.

Capex also needs watching. EIH incurred ₹690 crore of capex in FY26. Annual capex is expected to stay around ₹600-700 crore over next two years. The balance sheet can handle it, but free cash flow (four-year average is ₹450 crore) may remain modest in this phase.

Over long term, monitor any corporate action given EIH's low promoter holding (32.85 per cent) and strategic shareholders, including Reliance Strategic Business Ventures (18.8 per cent) and ITC (16.1 per cent).

Prune cables for protection from surge

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

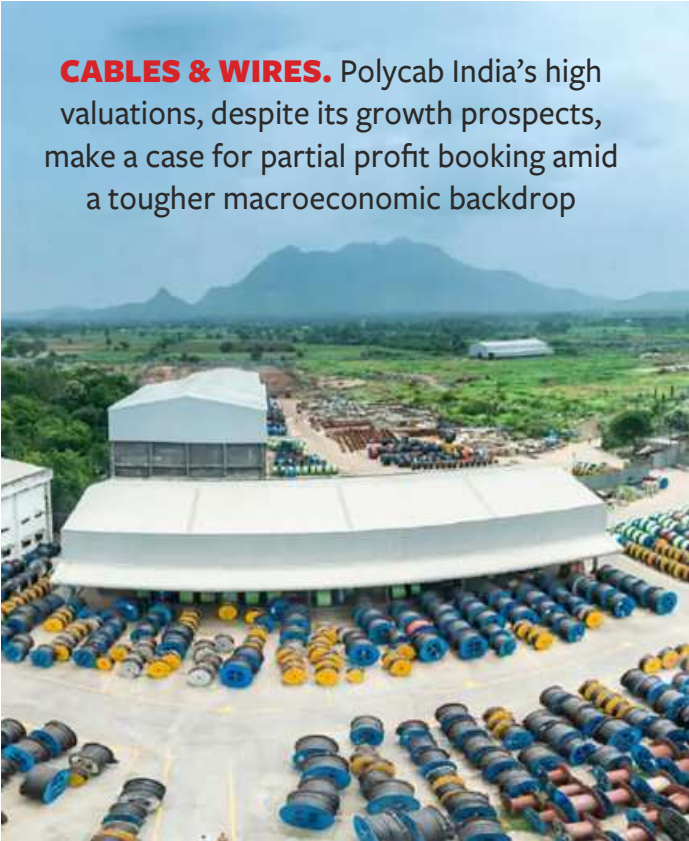
In August 2025, we had recommended investors to accumulate the stock of Polycab when the stock was trading at ₹7,085 and at 39 times one-year forward earnings. The tailwinds from heightened infrastructure and real estate activity, amplified by lower interest rates, supported the stock which has returned 33 per cent till now.

The stock, now trading at 43 times one-year forward earnings, is at a 16 per cent premium to last five-year average. While the company's growth outlook remains strong, it will taper to an extent, given the higher base of the last few years and macroeconomic conditions getting more challenging from here, including prospects of a rate hike. Hence, we now recommend investors to book partial profits from the stock. Growth prospects remain good, but given valuation and macroeconomic headwinds, investors can take some chips off the table.

WIRES AND CABLES
As shown in the figure, the company operates three divisions, which have delivered strong growth in the last three years.

Polycab is the country's largest manufacturer of wires and cables, with a scale more than double that of the second-largest player. The segment delivered a revenue CAGR of 26 per cent during FY23-26, driven by three key factors. First, higher infrastructure spending by the Central government, which grew at an 18 per cent CAGR over FY23-26 to ₹12 lakh crore in FY26, supported demand. Second, real estate activity in the top 10 cities had remained on an uptrend over the past three years, alongside growth in the affordable housing segment, aided by government support. Third, the rate-cut cycle that began last year, along with lower indirect and direct taxes, has further boosted demand in the construction segment.

Pricing has also played a part as Polycab passes any commodity price movement to the customer in a month. The segment repor-



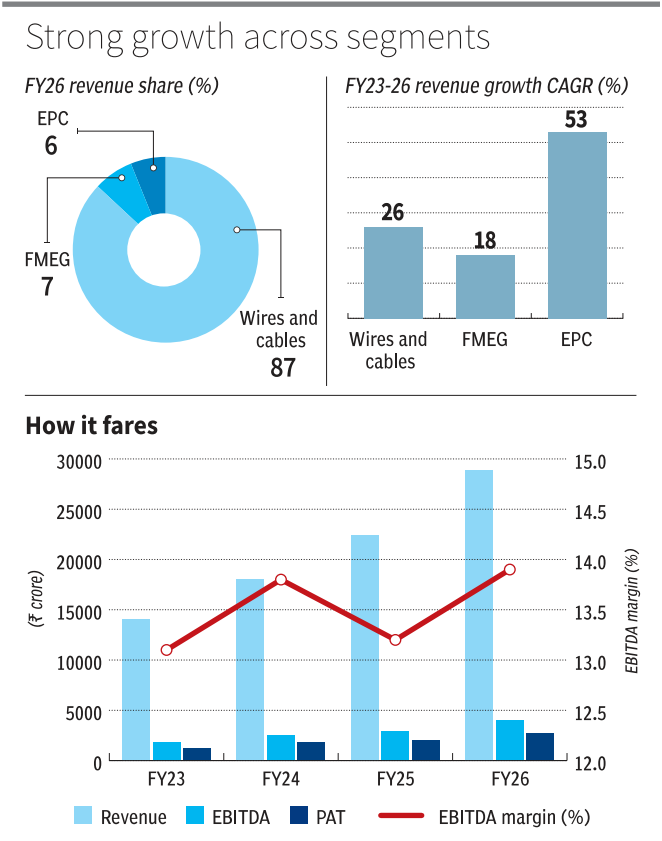
ted 18 per cent year-on-year volume growth in FY26 and price pass-through accounted for 13 per cent growth. Copper and aluminium prices soared last year internationally. This has been further stoked by the 11 per cent currency depreciation in FY26, especially for copper, which is largely imported.

For the next few years, Polycab is likely to sustain high growth based on the same factors as the last three years, but will face headwinds. Government spending on capital infrastructure has attained a strong base of ₹12.2 lakh crore, but the pace of expansion from here will moderate. This has been seen in FY26 itself with the allocation expanding only 9 per cent in FY26 Budget estimates. The impact to fiscal deficit due to the implications of the US-Israel-Iran war may limit the elbowroom for a high growth in capital expenditure. Real estate activity may have to face a scenario of rate hike cycle compared to expectations of rate cuts prior to the West Asia conflict. The high prices of copper and alu-

● BOOK PARTIAL PROFITS
Polycab India ₹9,552.65
WHY
● Strong rally year to date
● High base of comparison
● Premium valuations

minum will also be a minor headwind to volume growth in the short term.

FMEG AND EPC
Polycab's FMEG (fast moving electrical goods) is now led by solar division, which has more than doubled in each of the last two fiscals. The division manufactures solar cables, modules and inverters. With government support in the form of PM Surya Ghar and PM KUSUM, adoption of solar panels has grown exponentially, which has supported the segment growth. This is expected to continue despite the



high base attained for Polycab. The other two divisions of fans and lighting under the FMEG segment are facing only modest growth prospects, as competition has intensified. But the segment is aiming for higher profitability as it matures, which should drive bottom-line growth. The segment reported 4 per cent EBITDA margin and aims to generate 8-10 per cent EBITDA margins by FY30.

The EPC division, which undertakes cabling and related projects, will be anchored by two large projects. The company has a ₹8,000-crore order-book for the next three years under Bharat Net (high-speed Internet scheme with BSNL) and RDSS (power distribution scheme) projects, with an outlook for stable high single-digit margins for the next three years, and are underway.

FINANCIALS
Polycab has a strong balance sheet with net cash of ₹4,000 crore in March 2026. The company also has a strong capex plan of ₹1,200-1,800 crore for the next

five years. A large portion of the expansion will be focused on wires and cable capacity expansion. The company will start commercial production of extra high voltage cable (EHV), which will be an import replacement in India.

With strong tailwinds, the company has reported strong revenue/EBITDA/PAT growth of 27 per cent/29 per cent/28 per cent CAGR in FY23-26 as shown in the figure. The company performed well in FY26 with strong growth across segments and it also increased its market share in cables and wires in India from 25-26 per cent in FY25 to 31 per cent in FY26. On a high base, volatile macroeconomic outlook and high valuations, investors can book partial profits from the recent surge in the stock returns. The infrastructure focus on power and renewable capacity addition and continued momentum in real estate and affordable housing should support the largest and well-established player for the long run, nonetheless.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — **Editor**

Sensex ups & downs				
	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	June 5	June 12		
Kotak Mahindra Bank	377.5	403.4	▲	6.8
Axis Bank	1,273.2	1,355.6	▲	6.5
ICICI Bank	1,262.2	1,340.4	▲	6.2
SBI	977.8	1,016.9	▲	4.0
HDFC Bank	747.4	772.4	▲	3.4
Bajaj Finance	889.2	918.7	▲	3.3
Maruti Suzuki	13,048.6	13,371.3	▲	2.5
L&T	3,954.0	4,050.2	▲	2.4
Asian Paints	2,685.2	2,746.5	▲	2.3
HUL	2,120.8	2,167.6	▲	2.2
Ultratech Cement	10,910.8	11,108.0	▲	1.8
ITC	280.8	285.2	▲	1.6
Sun Pharma	1,783.6	1,807.3	▲	1.3
Bharti Airtel	1,799.0	1,822.6	▲	1.3
Reliance Industries	1,291.2	1,292.8	▲	0.1
M & M	3,040.8	3,043.4	▲	0.1
Power Grid	285.4	284.8	▼	-0.2
Bharat Electronics	408.1	406.6	▼	-0.4
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,823.1	1,813.3	▼	-0.5
Trent	2,774.7	2,754.8	▼	-0.7
Bajaj Finserv	1,703.1	1,689.3	▼	-0.8
TCS	2,198.3	2,161.5	▼	-1.7
Titan	4,260.0	4,187.1	▼	-1.7
Tata Motors PV	397.7	389.4	▼	-2.1
NTPC	361.7	354.0	▼	-2.1
Tech Mahindra	1,482.7	1,429.4	▼	-3.6
HCL Tech	1,154.5	1,109.2	▼	-3.9
Tata Steel	206.8	197.9	▼	-4.3
Eternal	256.5	243.8	▼	-4.9
Infosys	1,197.0	1,116.5	▼	-6.7

How sectoral indices moved				
	June 5	June 12	Movement	% change
BANKEX	61,478.6	63,987.8	▲	4.1
FMCG	17,926.8	18,140.0	▲	1.2
HEALTHCARE	46,908.4	47,388.3	▲	1.0
AUTO	57,632.9	57,912.6	▲	0.5
REALTY	5,995.8	6,010.5	▲	0.2
PSU	20,815.3	20,767.0	▼	-0.2
CONSUMER DURABLES	58,654.5	58,426.5	▼	-0.4
CAPITAL GOODS	80,010.9	78,891.9	▼	-1.4
OIL&GAS	26,555.6	26,151.1	▼	-1.5
TECK	14,907.9	14,568.4	▼	-2.3
POWER	8,135.3	7,920.4	▼	-2.6
METALS	43,212.5	42,004.5	▼	-2.8
IT	28,221.2	27,167.9	▼	-3.7

How other indices moved				
BANK NIFTY	54,496.3	56,814.8	▲	4.3
NIFTY 100	24,397.3	24,602.3	▲	0.8
NIFTY 200	13,527.0	13,618.6	▲	0.7
NIFTY 500	22,465.4	22,599.8	▲	0.6
NIFTY NEXT 50	70,192.0	70,007.2	▼	-0.3

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 Though my roots go back to one of the largest industrial families of the 1950s, it was the patriarch of the present promoter family, the founder's son-in-law, who turned my fortunes around from near closure.
- 2 I am now the largest player in India and the third-largest globally. All the products I have manufactured over the last 30 years, if laid end to end, can circle the earth five times.
- 3 While my group companies got embroiled in litigation and regulatory actions, I continued to retain my industry leadership.
- 4 The almost 50 per cent decline in my share price in recent months gave the promoters an opportunity to increase their stake substantially.
- 5 I have an 18-member board, unusually large for the size of my business. Seven of the nine non-independent directors are from the promoter family.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to **who-am-i@thehindu.co.in**, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Last week's stock: Aether Industries
Last week's winner: Palak Sangoi

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,623) and Nifty Bank (56,815) gained 1.1 per cent and 4.3 per cent respectively over the past week. The derivatives data suggests that the bearish sentiment seen over the previous fortnight has moderated considerably, although there is limited evidence of aggressive fresh long build-up.

FII (Foreign Institutional Investors) remained net short on index futures, but the position narrowed 9 per cent over the last week to 2.44 lakh contracts. They also reduced net short positions on index call options by 24 per cent to 2.09 lakh contracts. However, net long positions in index puts increased 2 per cent to 5.43 lakh contracts, indicating that institutional participants continue to maintain downside protection despite the recent rebound.

At the broader level, the positioning appears mixed. Combined net short positions (FII plus retail) on index futures increased 7 per cent to 63,223 contracts. On the other hand, net short positions on call options declined marginally from 1.89 lakh contracts to 1.86 lakh contracts, showing some moderation in bearish expectations. However, net put shorts fell sharply from 2.81 lakh contracts to 1.70 lakh contracts, suggesting that traders have become less willing to defend lower levels.

The derivatives data broadly aligns with the price action. Nifty has reclaimed an important resistance on the back of short covering, while Bank Nifty has displayed significantly stronger momentum by breaking above a key hurdle. Overall, bearishness has eased considerably but the data does not yet point to a decisive bullish positioning.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (Jun) (23,687) opened with a gap-down last



Monday and remained volatile through the week. Nevertheless, the contract largely traded sideways within the 23,150-23,400 range until Thursday.

On Friday, however, it rallied past 23,400 and closed above the resistance at 23,650. Notably, while the contract gained 1 per cent during the week, its Open Interest (OI) declined 7 per cent to 182 lakh contracts, indicating short covering.

The chart shows a key hurdle at 23,800, where a downward-sloping trendline coincides. A decisive breakout above this level can strengthen the bullish case and lift the contract to 24,150. Resistance above 24,150 is at 24,500.

On the other hand, if Nifty futures (Jun) declines from the current level, it can find support at 23,650 and 23,400. As long as the latter holds, the probability of a breakout above 23,800 will remain high.

Supporting the positive bias, the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of June options improved from 1.03 to 1.09. Although the increase was modest,

- NO DECISIVE SHIFT**
- Nifty reclaims a key level
 - Nifty Bank leads recovery
 - Options PCR improves

it reflects relatively greater put writing, indicating a favourable sentiment among option traders.

Strategy: Go long on Nifty futures (Jun) if it breaks out of 23,800. Place stop-loss at 23,600 and book profits at 24,150.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (Jun) (56,872) recovered swiftly after opening with a gap-down and witnessed a strong rally through the week. On Friday, the contract broke above the key hurdle at 55,800 and closed at 56,872, ending the week with a gain of 3.8 per cent.

Like Nifty futures, the rally was driven largely by short covering. As the June contract advanced last week, its OI declined 4 per cent to 24 lakh contracts. Further reinfor-

cing the positive bias, the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of June options improved from 0.92 to 1.10, indicating that put writing outpaced call writing during the period, a bullish signal.

The chart reflects strengthening upside momentum. While the contract could witness a corrective decline from the current level, possibly towards 56,000, such dips are likely to attract buyers. We expect Nifty Bank futures to eventually resume the uptrend and move up to 58,200.

On the other hand, if the contract slips below the resistance-turned-support at 55,800, the correction could deepen towards 55,000. However, given the recent breakout and improving derivatives positioning, the probability of a sustained decline below 55,800 appears low.

Strategy: Buy Nifty Bank futures (Jun) on a dip to 56,200. Place an initial stop-loss at 55,700. When the contract rises to 57,200 and 57,800, revise the stop-loss to 56,400 and 57,200 respectively. Book profits at 58,200.

Shorting: Futures vs underlying

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Shorts in the underlying can be carried through SLB mechanism

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

There are several reasons traders prefer futures to their underlying. Here, we discuss the benefits of trading futures when you have a negative view on an underlying.

TRADING EFFICIENCY
The first reason is obvious. Brokers do not typically allow retail traders to carry short stock positions overnight. A short position initiated during the day is typically closed by 3.15 pm to reduce risk. Note that SEBI regulation allows short positions in the underlying to carried over beyond a day through the securities lending and borrowing (SLB) mechanism. Suffice it to know that the procedure is tedious, and most traders may not prefer it. It is easier to short in the futures market. Why? In the spot market, you must deliver the underlying for the transaction to complete the next day (T+1). In the futures market, you are not required to deliver the asset till contract expiry. That means you can carry your short futures position and close it before expiry without being obligated to deliver the underlying. You are said



- TAX ADVANTAGE**
- Intraday losses on futures are treated as nonspeculative business income and can be carried forward for eight years and setoff against other business income

to carry a naked short position. The ability to carry a naked short position saves you the borrowing cost that you will incur if you short the underlying. Note that the borrowing cost depends on the demand for the shares, especially, by the short sellers.

The second reason is related to

OPTIONAL READING
Some may argue that the margin trading facility (MTF) in the spot market can offer similar benefits as leverage on futures. While MTF does offer leverage, it comes at a cost. These include interest cost (typically 0.04 per cent per day on the funded amount), pledge costs and brokerage commission. True, futures have costs too; futures price is typically greater than the spot market because of the interest factor. But if you were to compare the interest factor relating to futures with the cost of using the MTF in the spot market, the former is typically lower and easy to initiate.

income. This offers a tax advantage to trade futures even through intraday shorting in the stock can be initiated without incurring additional transaction cost. Then, there is the leverage effect. You require lower trading capital to short overnight positions in the futures market compared to shorting the underlying, assuming you avail the SLB mechanism.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Trend at crossroads Bears gain traction

BULLION CUES. Key levels hold the clue

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold (\$4,219/ounce) lost 2.5 per cent last week whereas silver (\$68/ounce) was up by a marginal 0.4 per cent. In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,50,528/10 gm) was down 3.3 per cent and silver futures (₹2,46,186/kg) slipped 0.9 per cent. Below is an analysis.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,50,528)
Gold futures (Aug) closing the week below ₹1,52,000 is a bearish signal. It made an intra-week low of ₹1,46,444 on Thursday before recovering, which was aided by the 200-day moving average at ₹1,46,750. While the contract has closed below ₹1,52,000, the chart shows that the breakdown is not decisive, keeping the chances open for a recovery. But only a breakout of ₹1,57,000 can truly turn the outlook positive.

In case the contract falls below ₹1,49,000, it could extend the drop to ₹1,44,000. So broadly, traders can wait for gold futures to breach either ₹1,49,000 or ₹1,57,000.

Trade strategy: Short gold futures with a stop-loss at



₹1,51,000 if it slips below ₹1,49,000. Exit at ₹1,44,000.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,46,186)
Silver futures (Jul), which declined in the first half, recovered in the last two sessions. The support at ₹2,30,000 helped the contract turn around. But to establish an uptrend, the contract ought to break out of ₹2,60,000, in which case the rally can lift the price to ₹2,85,000 quickly.

However, if silver futures falls below ₹2,35,000, the bears can drag the contract to ₹2,20,000. That said, the chart shows that silver is relative stronger than gold at the moment.

Trade strategy: Sell silver futures if the price declines below ₹2,35,000. Place initial stop-loss at ₹2,42,000. Book profits at ₹2,20,000.

CRUDE CHECK. Corrective rise may precede fall

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices declined over the past week and are testing some key levels. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$87.30/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹7,968/barrel) shed 6.2 per cent and 5.4 per cent respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$87.30)
Brent crude oil futures, since May 25, stayed within the price band of \$90 and \$98. Last Friday, it broke down below the support at \$90, a bearish signal. While the chart hints at the possibility of further decline, there is a minor support at \$86. This may not turn the outlook positive but can trigger a corrective rise, potentially to \$90-92 price region.

An eventual breach of \$86, either from the current level or after a rise to \$90-92, can lead to a downtrend to \$82 and subsequently to \$77.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹7,968)
Crude oil futures (Jul) breached a support at ₹8,100 on Friday and closed at ₹7,968, indicating that



the bears are potentially gaining fresh momentum.

As it stands, the likelihood of a fresh leg of downtrend is highly likely. While the nearest support is at ₹7,500, we anticipate a deeper decline to ₹7,250.

But that said, like in Brent crude futures, there is a chance for a minor recovery. The domestic crude futures (Jul) could rise to ₹8,300 before witnessing the next leg of a fall.

Trade strategy: Last week, we suggested shorting Crude futures (Jun) at ₹8,800 with stop-loss at ₹9,400 for a target of ₹7,600. Traders can book profits in this trade.

For fresh positions, instead of June futures, one can short July contract at ₹8,300. Target and stop-loss can be ₹7,250 and ₹8,800 respectively.

F & O QUERY



AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

I have a long position on BSE June futures bought at ₹3,907. What is the outlook?

Palani Shanmugam

BSE (₹4,041.10): After hitting a lifetime high of ₹4,446.80 on May 27, the stock reversed the path and declined. However, the trend has not turned bearish. In fact, the decline seems to have stabilised as the scrip has been consolidating between ₹3,840 and ₹4,080 since the beginning of June.

Until the support at ₹3,840 and ₹3,800 remains valid, the uptrend will not come under threat. After some more consolidation within the above-mentioned price levels, there is a good chance for the stock to break out of ₹4,080.

With respect to futures, the trading range has been ₹3,825-4,100 since early June. Once the contract breaks out of ₹4,100, it can see an upswing to ₹4,300 and possibly to ₹4,400. Nevertheless, from the perspective of trading, we suggest eyeing a target of ₹4,300. So, you may hold the long on BSE June futures for a target of ₹4,100. But place a stop-loss at ₹3,760.

I purchased TMPV 400-call of June series for a premium of ₹9.50. Kindly suggest the outlook

Prasad

TMPV (₹390): The stock of Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles (TMPV) has been in an uptrend since early April. The rally began on the back of the support at ₹295. But after hitting a high of ₹408 on May 29, the price moderated.

Nevertheless, the uptrend is not broken. The stock has just rebounded from the 21-day moving average, now at ₹378. The price band between ₹370-375 is a good base. So, there is a good chance for the stock to resume the rally. It is likely to hit ₹400 soon.

However, assuming that the stock appreciates to ₹400 over the next couple of weeks, the premium of June 400-call (currently at ₹4.90) can rise to around ₹7-8, which is less than your entry price. If the rally is quicker, the premium can go higher and vice-versa. Or the stock has to extend the rally beyond ₹400 to see a meaningful increase in premium.

Given the prevailing conditions, our suggestion would be to exit the trade when the premium rises to ₹7-8. After exiting, in case the stock breaks out of ₹400, you can consider buying call option again but of July series.

✉ Send your queries to derivatives@thehindu.co.in.

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Jun 12	Weekly change %	As on Jun 12	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	39971	54	258005	-10
Future Index Short	283594	-3	77605	-1
Net Futures	-243623	-9	180400	-13
Index Call options Long	623418	5	2499577	-22
Index Call options Short	832438	-4	2476544	-21
Net Call options	-209020	-24	23033	-74
Index Put options Long	1194064	22	3015372	34
Index Put options Short	651452	46	3727671	22
Net Put Options	542612	2	-712299	-12

FII have cut net short on index futures and have reduced net short on index calls. While there is a marginal increase in net long on index puts. Broadly, the bias is turning positive.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Jun 12)				
OIL	417.80	-13.6	409.2	71.4
RADICO	3,541.70	1.5	5.2	61.1
INDIGO	4,709.70	5.1	186.7	45.5
POWERINDIA	34,325.00	-6.9	15.3	35.3
MUTHOOTFIN	3,042.20	-3.5	96.9	35.3
FALL (as on Jun 12)				
SBIN	1,017.15	4.0	1693.9	-10.3
GODFRYPHLP	2,301.00	3.6	33.3	-9.9
PATANJALI	425.55	1.2	412.1	-9.4
FEDERALBNK	315.70	3.8	1609.1	-7.5
MAXHEALTH	1,012.45	3.6	215.5	-6.3

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Jun 15)

KAYNES

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on Jun 12)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Jun	375.3 (-2.4)	3,124 (-14)	Long unwinding
COPPER	30-Jun	1,335.4 (-0.1)	15,568 (-8)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOIL	20-Jul	7,968.0 (-5.4)	5,100 (86)	Short build-up
CRUDEOILM	20-Jul	7,970.0 (-5.4)	18,295 (66)	Short build-up
GOLD	5-Aug	1,50,528.0 (-3.3)	8,998 (2)	Short build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Jun	1,19,835.0 (-3.4)	13,551 (-6)	Long unwinding
GOLDM	3-Jul	1,48,719.0 (-3.2)	48,223 (-3)	Long unwinding
GOLDPETAL	30-Jun	14,989.0 (-3.5)	1,87,628 (-2)	Long unwinding
GOLDTEN	30-Jun	1,48,962.0 (-3.3)	31,390 (-4)	Long unwinding
LEAD	30-Jun	205.1 (-0.8)	424 (5)	Short build-up
NATURALGAS	25-Jun	296.7 (-3.9)	19,135 (26)	Short build-up
SILVER	3-Jul	2,46,186.0 (-0.9)	11,371 (-8)	Long unwinding
SILVERM	30-Jun	2,50,195.0 (-1.7)	24,010 (-12)	Long unwinding
SILVERMIC	30-Jun	2,50,335.0 (-1.7)	64,184 (-18)	Long unwinding
ZINC	30-Jun	368.8 (1.0)	2,544 (-3)	Short covering
CURRENCIES (as on Jun 12)				
USDINR	25-Jun	95.25 (0.1)	28,89,025 (8)	Long build-up
EURINR	25-Jun	110.35 (-0.5)	13,376 (2)	Short build-up
GBPINR	25-Jun	127.82 (-0.3)	32,891 (-1)	Long unwinding
JPYINR	25-Jun	59.92 (-0.2)	68 (-16)	Long unwinding

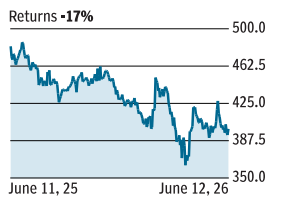
F&O Strategy

Buy LICI futures

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook for the stock of Life Insurance Corporation of India (LICI) (₹399.35) remains neutral. It has been moving in the narrow range of ₹360-440 and only a break away from this band will set a clear trend.

Immediate resistance and support appears at ₹410 and ₹383 respectively. A close above ₹432 has the potential to lift LICI to new highs. On the other hand, a close below ₹362 could drag the price to



₹325.

F&O pointers: LICI June futures closed at ₹398.05 and July futures at ₹398.90, at a discount to the spot price of ₹399.35. However, barring only a couple of days, the counter witnessed a steady build-up of open interest in the last one month. Options indicate a movement in a tight band of ₹400-420.

Strategy: Go long on LICI June futures by keeping an initial stop loss at ₹393. Shift the stop-loss to ₹397 if the stock opens on steady-to-positive note on Monday. Target can be ₹411. Traders can stay out if the stock opens below ₹395 or above ₹402 on Monday.

This stock is one of the low volatile ones and may move slowly. Still, going long in futures is a risky strategy and requires higher margin commitments. So, this is not suitable for risk-averse traders.

Follow-up: Hyundai Motor India moved on expected lines in the first couple of days, providing profit opportunities, but recouped sharply on Thursday and Friday.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Short Take

COT indicator

bl. research bureau

Commitment of Traders Report (COT/COTR) shows the positioning of market participants. Published every Friday by the Commodity Futures Trading Commission (CFTC) of the US, the report records the outstanding open interest of different asset classes.

Four main types of reports are legacy reports, supplemental reports, disaggregated reports and traders in financial futures (TFF) reports.

Legacy reports classify traders into two categories – commercial and non-commercial traders. Commercial traders include producers, hedgers, large physical



traders etc, whereas non-commercial traders include hedge funds and other large institutions. The supplemental report comprises 13 select agricultural commodities and segregates traders as commercial, non-commercial and index traders.

Disaggregated report categorises asset classes into agriculture, petroleum and products, natural gas and products, electricity and metals and other physical contracts. It separates traders into four categories namely Producer/Merchant/Processor/User, Swap dealers, Managed money and other reportable. Here, the first two are the commercials and the latter two are the non-commercials.

Traders in financial futures report cover financial products like stocks, bonds and currencies. The classification of traders is as Dealer/Intermediary, Asset manager/Institutional, Leveraged funds and other reportables.

Gurumurthy K

bl, research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index fell initially last week and then made a strong recovery towards the end of the week. Sensex and Nifty were up 1.7 per cent and 1.1 per cent respectively. As mentioned last week, Nifty Bank index outperformed by surging over 4 per cent last week.

The strong rise on Friday has given some relief for the Nifty and Sensex. They now have to get a strong follow-through rise from here and breach the upcoming resistance to strengthen the bullish case. Nifty Bank index on the other hand can continue to outperform in the coming weeks as well.

FPIS SELL

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) continue to sell heavily. The equity segment saw a net outflow of \$2.08 billion last week. June has seen a net outflow of about \$6.59 billion in just two weeks. The FPIs have to come back and start buying in order to push the Indian benchmark indices to new highs.

NIFTY 50 (23,622.90)

Short-term view: The fall to 23,000 and a bounce thereafter has also happened in line with our expectation. Nifty has risen back well from around 23,070.

Immediate resistance is in the 23,700-23,800 region. Support is at 23,350. If Nifty manages to sustain above 23,350 and breaks above 23,800 it will be bullish. Such a break can take it higher to 24,100-24,200 initially and then to 24,500-24,700 eventually in the short term.

Nifty has to decline below 23,350 to come under pressure for a fall to 23,000 or 22,850.

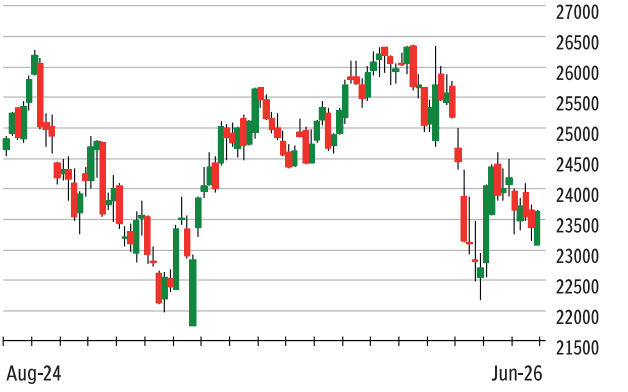
Medium-term view: The broader 22,000-26,500 range is intact. If the rise to 24,500-24,700 mentioned above happens now, it will give some relief. It will then increase the chances of seeing 26,500, the upper end of the range, eventually in the medium term.

The broader bias is positive. Nifty can make a bullish breakout above 26,500 and rise to 28,000-30,000 in the long term. It has to decline below 22,000 to



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Nifty 50: Bouncing back



negate this bullish view.

NIFTY BANK (56,814.80)

Short-term view: The rise to 56,700 happened as expected last week. Indeed, the index has risen well beyond our expected level. The outlook remains positive.

Support is in the 55,500-55,000 region. Immediate resistance is at 57,000. Nifty Bank index can break this resistance and rise to 58,000-58,500.

A fall below 55,000 is needed to drag the index down to 54,000-53,500 and turn the short-term picture negative.

Medium-term view: The broader outlook is bullish. In-

termediate resistance is at 60,500. A break above it can take the Nifty Bank index up to 65,000 over the medium term. That will keep the upside open to target 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

The region around 50,000 is a strong support. The index has to decline below this support to prove our bullish view wrong.

SENSEX (75,527.95)

Short-term view: The index has managed to sustain above 73,000 and has risen back well. Immediate resistance is at 75,730. A break above it can take the Sensex higher to 76,500-77,000 in the coming

IMMEDIATE RESISTANCE

- Nifty 50: 23,800
- Sensex: 75,730
- Nifty Bank: 57,000

weeks. That will also increase the chances of seeing 78,000 on the upside in the short term.

Immediate support is at 74,500. Sensex has to decline below this support to fall back to 73,000 again.

Medium-term view: The chances are increasing now for the Sensex to go up within the broad 71,000-86,000 range. A strong break above 80,000, the intermediate resistance, will clear the way for a rise to 86,000.

We retain our overall bullish bias. Sensex can break 86,000 eventually and rise to 90,000 and even 94,000 in the long term.

This bullish view will go wrong only if the index declines below 71,000.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150

(22,257.90)
The bounce last week from the low 21,698.50 keeps the 21,700-23,000 range intact. Intermediate resistance is around 22,400.

A break above it can take the Nifty Midcap 150 index up to 23,000, the upper end of the range. Failure to rise past 23,000 can drag the index down and will keep the sideways range intact for some more time.

There is no major change in the broader view. Crucial resistance is at 23,100. We expect the index to surpass this hurdle eventually. That will trigger a rally in Nifty Midcap 150 index to 26,000-26,500 initially and then to 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

The broader picture will turn negative only if the index declines below 20,800.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250

(17,079.10)
The index has risen back very well last week from the low of 16,602. Immediate resistance is in the 17,100-17,200 region. A decisive break above 17,200 can take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index up to 17,600 initially. A further break above 17,600 will clear the way to test 18,000-18,300, a crucial resistance region.

The broader bias is positive. We expect the index to breach 18,300 eventually. Such a break can take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index higher to 22,500-23,000 and even 24,000 in the long term.

If the index fails to breach 17,600 from here, it can fall back to 16,600 again or even to 16,300. The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index declines below 16,000. If that happens, then a fall to 15,000-14,800 is possible. However, such a fall looks less likely at the moment.

From a long-term perspective, 14,000 is an important support. The outlook will turn bearish only on a break below this support.



Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English



Tamil

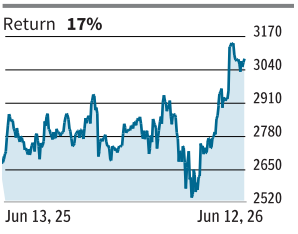


MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl, research bureau

Grasim Industries (₹3,105.35)

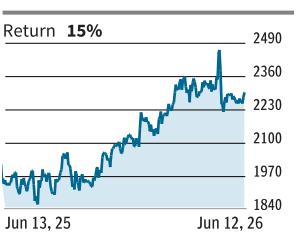
Set to resume rally



However, we anticipate the bulls to regain traction between ₹2,900 and ₹3,000, and embark on a fresh rally to ₹3,450. So, one can go long now at ₹3,105 and add longs at ₹2,950. Keep initial stop-loss at ₹2,780. When the price rises to ₹3,300 and ₹3,400, alter the stop-loss to ₹3,200 and ₹3,325. Book profits at ₹3,450.

Lupin (₹2,292.70)

Breakout anticipated



The stock of Grasim Industries appreciated about 12 per cent in May. The upswing resulted in the breakout of the resistance band of ₹2,900 and ₹3,000. Nevertheless, after hitting a record high of ₹3,198.10 on May 18, the price moderated. From the current level, there could be some more correction in price.

However, we anticipate the bulls to regain traction between ₹2,900 and ₹3,000, and embark on a fresh rally to ₹3,450. So, one can go long now at ₹3,105 and add longs at ₹2,950. Keep initial stop-loss at ₹2,780. When the price rises to ₹3,300 and ₹3,400, alter the stop-loss to ₹3,200 and ₹3,325. Book profits at ₹3,450.

Ramkrishna Forgings (₹592.05)

Signs of bullish reversal



The stock of Lupin has been consolidating since March. Barring the brief rally to ₹2,492 in early May, it has largely been trading between ₹2,200 and ₹2,380. Nevertheless, the long-term trend is bullish and prior to the ongoing sideways trend, the scrip saw a good rally. Now that the stock has remained compressed for quite some time, we expect it to see a strong breakout anytime soon. Such a move can lead to a swift rally, potentially to ₹2,700. Therefore, traders can buy Lupin now at ₹2,292 and accumulate at ₹2,210. Place stop-loss at ₹2,100. When the stock rises to ₹2,450 and ₹2,625, revise the stop-loss to ₹2,300 and ₹2,500 respectively. Exit at ₹2,700.

The price action of Ramkrishna Forgings since August 2025 shows that the trend has largely been flat. However, by taking a closer look, we can see bullish signals emerging. The weekly chart shows a confirmation of a double-bottom chart pattern and recently, the stock has formed a higher base at ₹550 where both 21- and 50-week moving averages coincide. So, broadly, we can see higher high and higher low and a bullish reversal pattern. Therefore, the potential for a rally is high. We expect the stock to touch ₹780. Buy at ₹592 and ₹550. Stop-loss can be ₹500. On a rally to ₹670 and ₹730, revise the stop-loss to ₹600 and ₹680 respectively. Exit at ₹780.

Bourses bounce back

US MARKET OUTLOOK. All eyes on Kevin Warsh's first FOMC meeting

Gurumurthy K

bl, research bureau

Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and NASDAQ Composite index extended their fall in the first half last week. However, the news that the US and Iran could be nearing peace deal halted the fall and triggered a strong bounce towards the end of the week. If there is an unexpected negative development on the US-Iran deal front, then the equity markets can reverse lower again.

FED WATCH

All eyes will be on the US Federal Reserve meeting outcome this week on Wednesday. This will be the first meeting under the new chairman Kevin Warsh. So, it will be important to see his stance on the future interest rate path. High inflation in the US has already shifted the market expectation for a rate hike later this year.

DOW JONES (51,207.11)

The intra-week fall below the psychological 50,000 level did not sustain. The index has bounced back sharply from the low of 49,914. Supports are at 50,350 and 50,000.

A follow-through rise from here can take the Dow Jones higher to 52,000-52,500 in the next few weeks.

We reiterate that the region around 52,500 is a strong resistance which can halt the current rally. There are good chances to get a corrective fall to 50,000-49,000 from around 52,500. So, as the Dow Jones approaches 52,500, it is important to turn cautious rather than becoming more bullish.

S&P 500 (7,431.45)

The S&P 500 index failed in its various attempts to get a strong follow-through selling below 7,300. A rise above 7,470 from here will ease the danger of a fall below 7,300 that was cautioned last week. It will then bring back the bullish chances of seeing 7,700-7,800 going forward.



REUTERS

FED WATCH

The outcome of the US Federal Reserve meeting on Wednesday will need a close watch to see the interest rate path for the rest of the year

The index has to get a sustained break below 7,300 for a fall 7,150-7,130. For this fall to happen, the S&P 500 index has to remain below 7,470. We will have to wait and see.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE

(25,888.84)
The index has risen back sharply from the low of 24,980.38 recovering all the loss. Support is around 25,650. If the index manages to sustain above this support, a rise to 26,350 or 26,500 is possible this week.

Failure to rise past 26,500 and a subsequent fall below 25,650 will be bearish. It will confirm that a top is in place. In that case, there is a danger of seeing 24,500-24,000 on the downside going forward.

As such the price action in the coming days is going to be very crucial for the NASDAQ Composite index.

DOLLAR INDEX

The dollar index (99.80) is struggling to get a sustained rise above 100. At the same time, it is not getting strong sellers also to drag it lower. The short-term trend is up. Important support is around 99.40. As long as the index stays above this support, the uptrend will remain intact. That will keep the chances high for the dollar index to breach 100 decisively and rise to 100.70 and even 101-101.20 in the coming weeks.

This rise will get negated only if the index declines below 99.40. If that happens, a fall to 98.80 can be seen.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.48 per cent) witnessed a sharp fall on Thursday following the strong decline in oil price.

The resistance at 4.6 per cent has held well and capped the upside for now. However, good support is around 4.4 per cent. If the yield sustains above this support, it can rise back to test the resistance at 4.6 per cent again.

From a medium-term perspective, a decisive break above 4.6 per cent will be bullish to see a rise to 4.8 per cent. We will have to wait and see if the trigger for this rise is coming from the Fed meeting on Wednesday.

The short-term picture will turn negative only if the yield declines below 4.4 per cent. If that happens, a fall to 4.3 per cent and even lower can be seen.

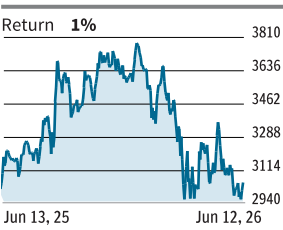
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl, research bureau

I have Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M) shares bought at ₹3,600. What is the long-term outlook?
Amit Kapoor

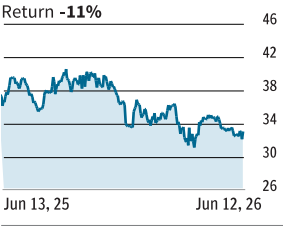
M&M (₹3,043): The medium-term picture is not looking good. The struggle to breach ₹3,400 since the beginning of this year indicates lack of fresh buyers in the market. Short-term supports are at ₹2,870 and ₹2,750. A decisive break below ₹2,750 will increase the danger of the share price tumbling towards ₹2,400-2,350 by this year-end. After this fall, a fresh rally might be possible. To avoid this fall, the stock has to sustain



above ₹2,750 first. Then a decisive break above ₹3,400 and a subsequent rise above ₹3,500 will only strengthen the bullish case for a fresh rally ₹4,300 or higher. Since there is a danger of more fall, better exit the stock now and accept loss. You can consider re-entering the stock again around ₹2,400.

I have Indian Overseas Bank (IOB) shares. My purchase price is ₹40. What is the outlook for the next three years?
U C Prabhu

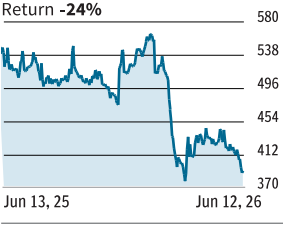
IOB (₹33.35): The trend is down since June 2024. There is a crucial support around ₹30 and ₹25. A fall beyond ₹25 is unlikely. Ideally, we can expect the stock to make a bullish reversal either from ₹30 itself or from ₹25. A subsequent rise above ₹40 will give a confirmation of the trend reversal. If that happens, there are good chances to see a rally to ₹85 over the next two years. You can buy more at current levels.



Keep a stop-loss at ₹22. Move it higher to ₹37 when the price goes up to ₹43. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹48, ₹65 and ₹72 when the share price touches ₹56, ₹74 and ₹80 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹85.

I have bought Matrimony.com shares at ₹480. What is the long-term outlook?
Sammaiah D, Bengaluru

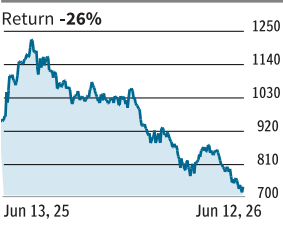
Matrimony.com (₹390): The stock is in a downtrend since August 2021. There is no sign of a trend reversal. The recent fall after failing twice to breach ₹470 indicates that the stock lacks fresh buyers. There is room to fall more. The share price can touch ₹350 or even ₹300 on the downside. From a long-term perspective, the region between ₹600 and ₹620 is a strong resistance. The stock has to surpass ₹620 to turn the outlook bullish. That looks



unlikely at the moment. Exit the stock and accept the loss. This is an illiquid stock. So, you may also find it difficult to get an exit and also the best price. Avoid choosing such stocks in the future. Always prefer to take positions in stock that has good liquidity.

I have bought EID Parry India shares. My purchase price is ₹890. What is the long-term outlook and where should I keep my stop-loss?
Ummachan Thomas

EID Parry India (₹729): The long-term trend is up since April 2020. The fall from the high of ₹1,247 made in July last year is just a correction. The crucial support at ₹700 can halt the current fall. A strong bounce from around ₹700 and a subsequent rise above ₹900 will mark the resumption of the broader uptrend. That will have the potential to take the price higher to ₹1,300 over the next one year. You can buy more now. Keep the stop-loss at ₹580. Revise it



higher to ₹860 when the price goes up to ₹980. Move the stop-loss further up to ₹1,000 and ₹1,180 when the price touches ₹1,170 and ₹1,250 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,300.

Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week	Last week's prize winner Afzar Alam
1 Aegis Vopak Terminals	Last week's winning stock Sheela Foam
2 Cera Sanitaryware	Closing price (June 5) ₹643.20
3 Bank of Maharashtra	Closing price (June 12) ₹703.25
4 Sheela Foam	Return: 9.34 per cent
5 Ramkrishna Forgings	

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were up 1.7 and 1.1 per cent respectively last week. BSE Bankex gained the most by 4.1 per cent, followed by BSE FMCG 1.2 per cent and BSE Healthcare 1 per cent. BSE IT and BSE Metal declined by 3.7 and 2.8 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Tech
P/E	20.4	20.4	33.3	14.4	55.6	64.4	33.1	41.6	19.0	18.8	8.2	36.1	11.1	36.6	19.7
P/BV	3.1	4.0	6.4	2.3	15.5	16.0	7.5	7.2	5.6	3.2	1.6	5.0	2.3	4.8	7.2
Dividend Yield	1.2	1.1	1.2	0.9	0.4	0.3	0.9	0.5	2.4	0.5	3.0	1.0	2.3	0.4	1.9
Weekly Return (%)	1.1 ▲	1.7 ▲	0.5 ▲	4.1 ▲	-1.4 ▼	-0.4 ▼	1.2 ▲	1.0 ▲	-3.7 ▼	-2.8 ▼	-1.5 ▼	-2.6 ▼	-0.2 ▼	0.2 ▲	-2.3 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	1.0 ▲	1.3 ▲	0.6 ▲	6.1 ▲	3.5 ▲	3.7 ▲	-2.8 ▼	2.9 ▲	-1.2 ▼	0.0 ▼	-2.7 ▼	0.3 ▲	-1.7 ▼	0.6 ▲	1.3 ▲
Annual Return (%)	-5.1 ▼	-7.5 ▼	10.3 ▲	1.2 ▲	13.1 ▲	1.8 ▲	-10.4 ▼	7.8 ▲	-28.3 ▼	35.5 ▲	-4.3 ▼	16.9 ▲	5.5 ▲	-23.0 ▼	-20.0 ▼
The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.															

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
360 ONE [1]	10956.6	29.9	36.6	4.5	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.9	20.0	14.3	20	1273.0	906.2
3M India	31542.8	542.7	58.1	16.6	202406	-0.3	21.6	30.0	23.3	-1.5	39.8	0	3830.0	0.28300.0
A B B [2]	6766.1	71.9	94.1	18.3	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	-5.5	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5
AB B Lifestyle	98.3	1.7	57.5	8.5	202603	11.9	57.7	12	29.4	-3.5	11.7	2.3	176.1	17.7
AB Real Estate	1139.4	-27.0	3.6	202603	79.1	-878.4	-66.4	-605.4	-3.2	-0.2	10	0.2	253.0	1080.1
Adhar Hsg. Fin.	473.9	25.3	18.7	2.8	202603	18.2	21.6	18.2	21.5	0.9	11.4	2.8	547.8	428.2
Aarti Industries [5]	440.5	11.4	38.8	2.7	202603	13.1	42.7	14.1	25.2	-3.9	6.2	0.7	52.29	33.8
AAVAS Financiers	1403.5	61.9	22.7	3.0	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	8.1	9.9	3.2	2152.0	1050.3
AACT India	262.71	73.04	3.60	11.7	202603	18.1	9.1	9.7	1.0	45.0	0.0	3992.1	3154.0	
ACC	1334.5	112.4	11.9	1.2	202603	16.9	-62.9	17.3	-9.0	0.3	11.2	0.0	2027.8	1250.7
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	335.6	7.1	47.1	3.0	202603	12.5	0.9	44.0	87.6	-5.8	7.4	2.8	364.5	195.1
Action Const.Eq. [2]	931.2	34.9	26.7	5.5	202603	7.1	-6.5	-1.4	1.4	3.6	4.0	0.0	1260.0	74.1
Adani Entergy Sol.	1487.2	19.0	78.3	7.0	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	-5.8	9.5	1.9	1614.0	745.5
Adani Contrl. [1]	2920.3	16.7	174.6	4.8	202603	20.3	-124.0	-2.6	-48.0	-4.2	5.6	1.5	3058.7	1753.5
Adani Green	1485.1	11.2	132.4	12.7	202603	9.1	40.7	11.6	8.5	-2.6	8.0	5.7	1544.7	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1813.3	56.3	32.2	4.4	202603	26.5	11.4	27.1	14.9	-0.5	13.8	0.7	1857.6	1290.0
Adani Power [2]	222.9	6.7	33.5	6.9	202603	0.1	-52.3	-3.5	-0.8	-4.1	16.6	0.8	254.2	105.7
Adani Total Gas [1]	728.3	6.0	122.1	16.5	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	-4.5	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	1100.3	33.8	32.6	7.9	202603	6.9	-18.0	9.5	5.0	4.9	35.5	0.0	1122.8	708.0
Aditya Bk. Finc.	60.0	-6.1	1.3	202603	15.7	-184.0	11.2	-4.9	-0.3	0.0	1.3	95.0	53.6	53.6
Aditya Bk. Cap.	358.0	14.5	24.7	2.7	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	0.1	9.5	4.4	375.0	235.8
Aegle Logistics [1]	544.6	25.6	36.9	5.5	202603	52.2	45.7	23.2	35.4	22.5	14.5	0.9	976.0	576.0
Aegis Vopak Term	218.2	2.3	95.7	5.6	202603	22.2	17.6	25.8	75.0	14.9	7.0	2.5	302.0	158.8
Aether Industri.	1143.9	17.0	67.1	6.2	202603	27.0	4.8	38.3	35.3	0.5	9.7	0.1	1274.2	732.2
Aether Infrastr.	326.3	2.5	38.5	2.2	202603	18.3	-170.7	-8.8	-4.7	2.0	14.4	0.6	479.1	265.5
Affle 3E [2]	1447.2	32.3	44.8	5.6	202603	20.3	16.0	19.5	19.1	-1.8	16.6	0.1	2186.8	1251.5
AIJA Engineering [2]	4330.7	136.4	31.8	5.0	202603	9.6	37.9	0.1	19.9	-6.5	19.1	0.1	4780.0	3001.9
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3129.4	84.5	36.8	2.6	202603	21.5	18.4	17.3	26.9	0.1	31.0	0.0	3344.8	2335.0
Ajanta Pharm [2]	743.1	37.0	20.1	2.6	202603	20.4	40.8	10.1	26.9	0.8	13.1	0.1	1991.7	975.0
Alkerm Lab [2]	5296.1	201.8	27.2	4.6	202603	14.6	13.6	13.5	11.1	4.9	0.0	0.0	5933.0	4716.8
Alkyl Amines [2]	1830.7	35.2	52.0	6.1	202603	0.2	-1.4	-2.3	-3.3	0.1	18.2	0.0	2488.8	1212.4
Allied Blenders [2]	644.8	8.2	78.3	10.9	202603	0.4	-48.1	11.4	18.2	11.2	21.0	0.9	720.0	32.0
Aurobindo Pharma [2]	122.2	-1.6	21.3	12.9	202603	0.5	-1.3	-3.2	-0.9	-4.1	2.2	0.0	25.0	12.1
Amar Raja Ener. [1]	823.5	38.5	21.4	1.9	202603	15.5	11.6	7.5	-18.9	-3.2	15.6	0.0	1058.0	671.5
Amber Enterp.	7420.7	57.1	130.0	6.0	202603	0.5	-26.8	22.2	-17.7	-5.2	13.5	0.8	8970.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	423.2	20.0	21.1	1.8	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.5	1.4	6.7	0.0	625.0	394.0
Anand Rathi Wea. [5]	1764.4	23.8	74.0	29.4	202603	29.6	44.5	22.3	32.1	0.5	56.8	0.1	1991.7	975.0
Anand Ray [2]	534.7	10.8	49.7	4.4	202603	18.4	34.7	20.0	18.3	0.9	14.1	0.0	243.0	130.0
Angel One [1]	339.5	10.0	33.9	5.1	202603	38.2	83.5	-1.9	-21.9	-2.0	34.8	1.0	351.0	289.0
Apur Inds.	15238.0	249.1	61.2	11.4	202603	26.6	3.7	23.3	21.8	9.9	32.6	0.1	15348.4	6800.0
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	1818.0	43.3	42.0	9.5	202603	14.1	20.9	9.7	58.9	-0.3	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1493.0
Arcelor Hospitals [2]	845.5	1.8	27.4	18.9	202603	15.4	15.8	18.3	35.3	0.7	28.9	0.0	1083.5	500.5
Apollo Tyres [1]	396.1	33.6	11.8	1.5	202603	14.2	254.7	9.0	72.5	0.0	10.9	0.3	540.3	365.4
Apus Value Hou. [2]	272.2	18.8	14.5	2.7	202603	18.7	26.0	25.2	25.5	-2.6	15.1	1.5	364.9	193.5
Asahi India Hal.	879.6	13.9	63.4	5.7	202603	15.5	43.2	7.8	-1.7	-2.3	13.1	0.9	1070.0	689.8
Asahi Lloyds [1]	444.5	1.8	27.4	18.9	202603	15.1	16.6	18.1	4.2	-2.0	0.0	32.6	125.0	125.0
Asian Paints [1]	2746.5	46.5	59.3	12.3	202603	10.8	43.6	5.1	13.2	2.3	24.4	0.1	2985.5	2116.0
Aspirin DM Health.	815.0	7.8	104.7	10.0	202603	18.2	39.7	12.2	17.6	0.	11.6	0.5	868.0	519.8
Aspen Dental [2]	111.6	7.7	14.5	1.5	202603	12.1	21.1	12.1	20.8	-2.9	11.7	0.0	125.0	62.5
Astrazeneca Phr. [2]	8243.9	76.6	107.7	23.6	202603	20.4	26.6	32.6	32.6	-0.4	32.9	0.0	91065.1	7430.0
Atul Small Finance [1]	102.82	13.4	7.4	15.3	202603	73.7	-142.8	62.8	36.9	-0.5	0.0	1.1	106.8	30.6
Atul	6513.6	230.3	28.3	3.1	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	-2.4	12.8	0.0	7793.0	5563.0
Atul Energy Finance	102.82	13.4	7.4	15.3	202603	73.7	-142.8	62.8	36.9	-0.5	0.0	1.1	106.8	30.6
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1472.3	61.1	24.1	2.3	202603	4.4	2.0	6.4	1.8	0.7	14.2	0.2	1550.0	1017.0
Autum Invest [1]	528.4	22.7	23.2	3.1	202603	-78.6	-96.6	-43.0	-54.5	14.3	29.7	0.1	683.5	400.0
Avens Super Fund.	3992.5	45.5	87.7	10.6	202603	18.9	19.2	15.9	9.7	-3.7	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7
Axis Bank [2]	125.3	10.5	11.9	1.1	202603	13.1	19.8	11.9	19.8	0.0	11.7	0.0	125.0	101.0
Axis Bank [2]	135.6	8.4	16.0	2.0	202603	5.3	1.7	4.1	-6.0	6.5	0.0	0.0	1418.1	104.1



Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
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Cancer can pose a significant financial risk because both the likelihood of a diagnosis and the cost of treatment are high. Studies indicate that one in ten Indians may be diagnosed with cancer during their lifetime.

At the same time, cancer treatment has advanced rapidly. New therapies such as antibody-based drugs, gene therapies, and targeted treatments are expanding options, while medical technologies now help detect and operate on areas once beyond surgical reach. But because many of these therapies and technologies are recent, and some may still be experimental, the cost of cancer treatment in India remains very high.

This reinforces cancer as a high-impact financial risk with a relatively high incidence rate. Having a health insurance safety net is crucial, especially for those with a genetic predisposition. We detail a few options for building coverage with a focus on cancer protection, along with the shortcomings of each method.

STANDARD INSURANCE
A standard health insurance cover, with an emphasis on can-

cer protection, should have a sum insured of more than ₹50 lakh, considering the cost of treatment.

Given that a ₹1-crore policy may cost around ₹15,000 a year for a 30-year-old male, compared with around ₹8,000 a year for a ₹5-lakh cover, the case for a higher cover is strong.

The cost of cancer treatment may range from a few lakh rupees to ₹25-30 lakh, depending on the therapy prescribed, the type of cancer and the medication used. Monoclonal antibodies (MABs), antibody drug conjugates (ADCs), cell and gene therapies, and CAR-T are some of the main treatments used today.

These are newer treatments and many are still protected by patents. This means cheaper generic versions may not be available in India yet, though some may become available in the next few years, especially for earlier MAB and ADC drugs.

Standard health insurance policies now cover the cost of these medicines under the modern treatment category, following IRDAI guidance. Earlier, many insurers treated them as experimental and did not cover them.

As these treatments are expensive, it is important to choose a standard health insur-

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Cancer incidence and cost of treatment are increasing
- Standard policies need high coverage
- Critical illness riders can also help

ance policy with a high cover amount.

CRITICAL ILLNESS RIDERS
Standard health insurance is an indemnity product, which means claims are paid based on the actual expenses incurred. This can be troublesome in two ways.

As mentioned earlier, therapies deemed experimental were not covered. Also, chemotherapy may be classified as inpatient day care or outpatient treatment, depending on the procedure, with claims approved only if the policy covers that category. This shows that claim-based coverage for cancer care is subject to the insurer's terms and conditions. A claim rejection based on any one of several policy conditions can be disastrous in cancer care.

Another concern is that while actual medical expenses may be covered, cancer can affect the

income of both the patient and the caregiver, which standard health insurance does not cover.

These two shortcomings can be addressed through a critical illness rider or add-on, which provides a lump-sum payment when disease-specific criteria are met for any one of 30-40 listed critical illnesses. Premiums for critical illness cover from Care Health start at ₹1,600 for a ₹25-lakh sum insured covering 32 illnesses.

A lump-sum payout of the sum insured comes with its own set of conditions, which the policyholder must understand. For cancer, policyholders should check conditions such as “first instance”, which means only the first diagnosis is covered, and “specific severity”, which refers to the disease stage or complexity required for claim admission.

In Aditya Birla's policy, for instance, 50 per cent of the sum insured is paid for early-stage cancer and 100 per cent for major-stage cancer. The policy also provides a 150 per cent payout for advanced-stage cancer.

HDFC ERGO ICAN
Halfway between the two is HDFC Ergo's iCan cancer insurance plan. This is a cancer-only insurance plan that offers a lump-sum payout on detection of cancer.

The standard health insurance coverage includes conventional and advanced treatments, as well as inpatient and outpatient treatments ranging from chemotherapy to stem cell transplantation.

Additionally, the policyholder can receive 60 per cent of the sum insured as a lump-sum payout if cancer of specified severity is detected, or 100 per cent for advanced-stage cancer. After the lump-sum payout for cancer is made, the standard health cover for cancer continues. However, as mentioned, this policy is specifically designed to cover cancer alone and not other conditions.

There is a 120-day waiting period, which is longer than the 30-day waiting period in standard health insurance. Also, the Pre-Existing Disease (PED) conditions are marginally more stringent, as they include existing signs and symptoms at any time before the date on which the policy was issued.

While standard health insurance is an absolute necessity, critical illness riders or cancer-specific policies such as HDFC Ergo's iCan may add more protection for the policyholder. If there is a family history of cancer, policyholders may consider adding one of these options to their coverage.

SIMPLYPUT.

Significance of a log chart

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Mark came to meet Antony after his one-month official trip.

Mark: Hi Antony, how are you?

Antony: Hey Mark, I am good. How are you and how was your trip?

Mark: Yeah, the trip was nice.

Antony: I have been eagerly waiting for you to come back.

Mark: Oh really, you missed me so much at work?

Antony: No man, not at work but to continue our discussion.

Mark: Discussion? On what?

Antony: Before you left for your trip, you explained to me the basics of log chart.

Mark: Yes.

Antony: You promised to tell me how to use the log chart for analysis and what the advantages are in our next discussion.

Mark: Of course, I remember, Antony. If you have time, then we can talk right away.

Antony: Sure, we can.

Mark: So, let's go for a coffee and as we walk, brief me on what you recollect from our previous conversation.

Antony: Yeah, why not? A log chart captures the percentage movement between two points rather than the absolute values. It explains abnormal price swings and can be used for

analysing long-term historical price data.

Mark: Perfect

Antony: Now, tell me how can I use the log chart for my analysis?

Mark: As I told you earlier, log chart works well on very long historical data, say 30-40 years or even more. So, you have to use at least the monthly price data and should not go below that.

Antony: Meaning?

Mark: That is, you use daily, weekly charts etc for analysis, right?

Antony: Yes.

Mark: Always remember that when you are using log chart, it is ideal to have monthly chart as the lowest time frame. You can use quarterly or even yearly data/charts, when your historical data runs to say 50-100 years or so.

Antony: I can do analysis on the quarterly, yearly etc in an absolute price chart itself. So, what is unique about using a log chart for long-term analysis?

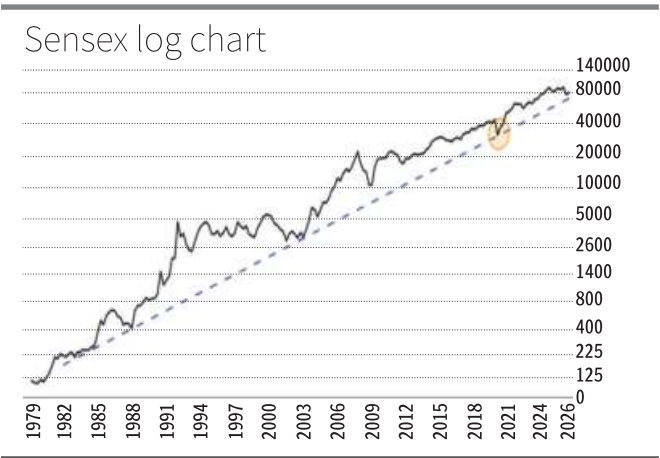
Mark: Log chart can give you support and resistance at crucial junctures, which will not be available in an absolute price chart.

Antony: Is it?

Mark: Yes. Not all the time, but sometimes.

Antony: Can you give me an example?

Mark: Why not? Open your



laptop and pull out the Sensex chart.

Antony: Give me a minute

Mark: Take your time, I will get you a coffee.

Antony: Yes please.

Mark: Here is your coffee, Antony. Have you got the Sensex chart?

Antony: Yeah.

Mark: See the quarterly (three-month) candle chart for, say, 1980.

Antony: What 1980? But Sensex was launched in 1986.

Mark: The official launch was in 1986. But the base is taken as 100 on April 1979. So, the retroactive data since then is available.

Antony: Oh ok. I have got the chart from 1980.

Mark: Now, take the low of the second quarter (April-June) candle of 1983, connect it with the low of the second quarter of 1988 and draw a trendline. Tell me what you observe.

Antony: Yes, this trendline has given support before the rally in 2003 and 2020.

Mark: Correct. But it is important to note here that the support that was given in 2020 is during the Covid-19 market crash.

Antony: Yes, the trendline touches the first quarter (January-March) low of 2020.

Mark: Exactly. So, if you had used a log chart then after seeing the bounce in the second quarter of 2020, you would have been convinced to enter the

market rather than sitting with panic.

Antony: Absolutely.

Mark: So, this is the major advantage of using a log chart. Look at the recent move from 2024 in Sensex on the monthly chart.

On the log chart, you will get a trendline support 71,700 by connecting the January and June 2024 lows.

See where you get the support on the absolute chart for the same trendline.

Antony: Let me draw the trendline and see. Oh, it is coming lower.

Mark: Where?

Antony: Around 71,100.

Mark: You are correct. So, if the market falls more from here, then these two are the levels that one has to keep an eye on.

Antony: Yeah, I will watch those levels closely.

Mark: Antony, let me finish this conversation on a cautious note. Whatever we have discussed here are just to make you understand the concept of log charts. Do not take it as a specific recommendation.

Antony: Not at all. I will now go and study more log charts and compare it with the absolute charts.

Mark: Yes. Only then you will understand more on how the chart works and will get a clear idea.

Health insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male, non-smoker, sum insured of ₹10 lakh living in a metro city

Insurer	Plan name	Key features	Premium (₹)
ICICI Lombard	Elevate	OPD rider with no sub-limits. Single pvt AC Room. ₹2 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,792
Care	Care Supreme	Guaranteed 7x increase over 5 years with rider. No Room Rent Limit. ₹15 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover.	10,838
Niva Bupa Health	Health ReAssure	Unlimited claims up to the cover amount. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	12,033
Star Health	Super Star	Fully loaded plan with one-time unlimited claim. Unlimited bonus. Lock the age till 50. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB.	8,173
Aditya Birla Health	Activ One Max	100% issuance offer guarantee. No Room Rent Limit. ₹10 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover	8,828
Tata AIG	Medicare Select	Special discount for young families and salaried customers. Single pvt AC Room. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,474
Reliance General	My HealthCare	Additional 30% discount on premium & fully customisable plan. Single pvt AC Room. ₹3.33 lakh NCB. Restoration of cover once a year.	7,326

Date: June 12, 2026. Source: www.policybazaar.com. NCB: No Claim Bonus

Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to	Max policy term	Annual premium		Claim settlement ratio (%)
		(years)		Male	Female	
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan	85	55	11,167	9,203	98.4
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,714	8,832	99.3
Canara HSBC Life	Young Term Plan - Life Secure	99	69	11,345	9,477	99.2
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	12,390	10,531	99.7
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	14,462	9,645	99.3
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,217	9,527	99.7
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	99.4
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,111	9,429	99.4
Bandhan Life	iTerm Prime	70	40	11,466	9,963	99.7

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer
Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: June 12, 2026

Safe Investing • bl • 9

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.85	6.4	6.4	May 06
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5	May 27
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.5	6.7	6.25	6	Jun 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.8	6.75	6.05	Jun 05
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.35	6.35	Jun 01
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.6	6.65	6.1	6	Jun 01
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	Jun 12
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7.35	6.5	5.75	Apr 06
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	May 29
DCB Bank	6.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	Jun 01
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	7.1	6.5	7.25	Jun 01
Federal Bank	6.5	7.35	7.35	6.75	Jun 10
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Jun 12
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.25	7.25	7.15	Apr 18
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	7	6.65	Jun 01
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	7	6.15	6.15	Jun 08
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	Jun 10
Karur Vysya Bank	7	7.2	6.55	6.55	Jun 08
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	May 14
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	6.75	Jun 02
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	7.1	7.75	7	Jun 10
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	7.75	7.75	6	May 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.3	7.5	7.77	Jun 02
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.4	7.25	7.55	05-Jun

Data as on respective banks' website on 12 Jun 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

ALERTS.

Introduction of 'StAR NPS' platform

In order to facilitate wider digital access and streamline subscriber onboarding under the National Pension System (NPS), BSE Technologies has operationalised the 'StAR NPS' platform for use by Points of Presence (PoPs) within the NPS architecture. The platform is intended to provide a technology-enabled assisted onboarding journey for NPS subscribers through PoPs and various Pension Agents.

Interest rates on home loans (%)

Institution	Loan amount		
	Under ₹30 lakh	₹30 to 75 lakh	Over ₹75 lakh
BANKS (Floating rates)			
Axis Bank	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10
Bank of Baroda	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95
Bank of India	7.10-10	7.10-10	7.10-10
Bank of Maharashtra	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65
Canara Bank	7.15-10	7.10-10	7.05-9.90
Central Bank	7.10-8.75	7.10-8.75	7.10-8.75
DBS Bank	<=8.70	<=8.70	<=8.70
Dhanlaxmi Bank	>=7.65	>=7.65	>=7.65
Federal Bank	7.30-9.50	7.30-9.50	7.30-9.50
HDFC Bank	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20
ICICI Bank	>=7.50	>=7.50	>=7.50
Indian Bank	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55
IOB	7.10-8.20	7.10-8.20	7.10-8.20
IDBI Bank	7.35-11.95	7.35-11.95	7.35-11.95
J&K Bank	>= 7.25	>= 7.25	>= 7.25
Karnataka Bank	7.47-11.70	7.47-11.70	7.47-11.70
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	>=7.60	>=7.60	>=7.60
Punjab National Bank	7.25-9.10	7.20-9.10	7.20-9.10
Punjab & Sind Bank	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70
RBL Bank	>= 9.0	>= 9.0	>= 9.0
State Bank of India	7.25-8.45	7.25-8.45	7.25-8.45
South Indian Bank	>=7.20	>=7.20	>=7.20
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30
BANKS (Fixed rates)			
Bank of Baroda	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95
Canara Bank	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75
Indian Bank	9.20-9.40	9.20-9.40	9.20-9.40
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Floating rates)			
Tata Capital	>=7.50	>=7.50	>=7.50
PNB Housing	7.75-10.05	7.60-10.05	7.50-9.95
Central Bank Housing	10-12.85	10-12.85	10-12.35
Samman Capital	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
Aditya Birla Housing Fin	>=7.75	>=7.75	>=7.75
Bajaj Finserv	7.25-20	7.25-20	7.25-20
GIC Housing Finance	>=8.80	>=8.80	>=8.80
Sundaram Home Finance *	>=10.65	>=10.65	>=10.65
Piramal Finance Limited	>=9.99	>=9.99	>=9.99
IIFL Home Finance	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
LIC Housing Finance	7.15-9.65	7.15-9.75	7.15-10.10
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Fixed rates)			
LIC Housing Finance	10-10.25	10-10.25	10-10.25

Rates that vary with tenures or credit score within the specified loan amounts are indicated as a range. Fixed interest rates may be subject to a revision after a specified tenure. Rates may also apply only for a definite period and change to floating thereafter. Data taken from respective bank's website as on June 12,2026. Contributed by BankBazaar.com. * Annual percentage rate;



bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	59.5	16323	1.4	0.5	-5.0	10.6	9.5	13.2	0.29
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	105.7	76297	1.1	0.7	-3.2	13.4	12.8	13.6	0.43
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	87.4	51660	3.5	2.8	-2.7	13.4	14.5	14.2	0.48
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1091.6	37808	1.5	1.0	-3.1	11.1	11.5	12.6	0.36
*****	JM Large Cap	147.3	416	2.8	1.3	-2.6	11.5	10.8	10.6	0.32
*****	Kotak Large Cap	549.0	10516	1.8	0.7	-3.2	11.3	10.1	12.1	0.31
*****	SBI Large Cap	91.6	53527	1.5	0.8	-0.1	10.6	10.7	11.9	0.34
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	498.4	28640	1.4	0.8	-4.6	10.8	10.4	11.6	0.32
***	Bandhan Large Cap	74.9	2001	1.8	0.8	-1.0	12.7	11.0	12.3	0.33
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	213.2	2550	1.7	0.7	-2.5	12.4	11.0	12.2	0.34
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	80.4	1422	2.1	0.7	-3.7	10.2	10.2	12.3	0.31
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	975.7	7145	1.5	1.0	-3.5	10.6	10.2	10.3	0.24
***	Invesco India Largecap	68.4	1749	1.8	0.7	-0.4	13.7	12.0	12.4	0.35
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	108.3	37692	1.3	0.5	-2.9	9.6	8.9	12.5	0.26
***	Tata Large Cap	494.4	2682	1.7	0.8	-0.7	11.4	10.7	11.7	0.33
***	UTI Large Cap	256.1	11853	1.9	1.1	-6.0	8.6	8.0	11.1	0.22
***	DSP Large Cap	448.4	7175	1.5	0.7	-5.2	12.9	10.4	11.2	0.33
***	HSBC Large Cap	456.8	1758	2.1	1.2	-1.5	10.9	9.5	11.7	0.26
**	LIC MF Large Cap	51.8	1330	3.6	2.4	-7.5	7.9	7.3	10.0	0.19
**	Union Largecap	22.5	436	2.1	1.3	-3.3	9.2	8.7	-	0.25
**	Axis Large Cap	57.5	30005	1.6	0.7	-3.9	9.0	6.6	11.5	0.15
*	Groww Largecap	41.7	129	2.7	1.4	-1.0	10.8	9.6	10.7	0.26
**	PGIM India Large Cap	321.1	535	2.5	0.9	-4.8	7.3	6.7	9.7	0.17
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.5	687	2.0	0.6	-6.5	9.6	8.5	-	0.24
-	Taurus Large Cap	152.5	51	2.1	1.9	-2.2	12.2	9.8	9.8	0.28

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	136.0	17461	1.4	0.4	2.9	20.5	16.7	15.5	0.53
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	332.4	28515	1.6	0.8	-1.3	15.7	15.1	14.4	0.48
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	990.3	30147	1.4	0.7	-0.6	17.1	16.6	15.3	0.59
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	33.3	15879	2.0	0.9	3.7	14.7	13.1	-	0.37
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	120.9	3424	1.9	0.7	3.7	17.6	15.2	15.5	0.43
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	629.3	39424	1.7	1.0	3.4	14.5	14.1	14.7	0.47
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	178.3	5964	1.8	1.0	0.3	17.9	14.8	13.9	0.50
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	89.3	473	2.1	1.0	1.7	14.5	12.3	12.6	0.38
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	240.7	24490	1.4	0.5	-5.6	12.4	11.1	14.6	0.34
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	607.2	17370	1.4	0.5	-1.3	16.6	12.9	14.8	0.40
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	86.4	4557	1.9	0.5	0.5	15.1	13.1	14.3	0.40
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	101.5	10153	1.5	0.5	3.3	22.0	16.7	15.9	0.46
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	339.1	30127	1.6	0.6	0.8	15.1	14.0	15.1	0.42
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	150.0	42792	1.3	0.5	1.3	14.2	11.6	16.4	0.35
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1444.7	7233	1.8	1.1	0.2	17.2	14.7	12.9	0.46
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	182.3	3392	1.7	1.1	-3.7	13.2	10.4	11.3	0.32
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	36.9	2983	3.5	2.3	-5.0	14.4	11.9	14.2	0.36
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	84.2	6690	1.8	0.8	0.7	13.3	12.4	14.0	0.37
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	486.0	7789	1.5	0.6	-7.8	8.6	10.0	12.3	0.30
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	896.6	5666	1.6	0.9	-0.2	12.2	8.5	11.4	0.22
*	Navi Large & Midcap	35.2	303	2.1	0.5	-0.1	10.2	10.9	12.6	0.31
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	28.7	5110	3.1	2.0	10.2	18.9	15.1	-	0.38

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1959.9	101822	1.3	0.7	0.2	17.1	16.8	15.8	0.59
*****	JM Flexicap	94.2	5069	2.6	1.4	-2.5	15.9	15.7	16.2	0.47
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	81.5	141447	1.1	0.5	-2.6	14.7	14.0	16.7	0.54
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.5	3374	1.9	0.5	0.2	14.8	13.0	14.3	0.39
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1553.0	18797	1.4	0.8	-5.1	13.9	13.0	13.0	0.39
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.1	5733	1.9	0.6	-1.8	9.7	8.7	13.5	0.24
*****	Union Flexi Cap	49.5	2289	1.7	0.8	-2.0	11.8	10.9	12.7	0.33
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1841.2	26032	1.4	0.7	3.7	15.9	12.0	14.0	0.37
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	204.1	7257	1.5	0.9	-1.3	12.7	11.0	10.8	0.33
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	328.0	13010	1.5	0.5	-2.4	11.6	10.3	13.8	0.32
***	DSP Flexi Cap	99.4	11798	1.5	0.6	-3.2	12.8	10.5	14.0	0.29
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	220.0	5538	2.3	1.5	1.3	16.9	13.5	12.8	0.38
***	Kotak Flexicap	83.4	54801	1.4	0.6	-1.3	13.4	11.5	13.4	0.34
***	SBI Flexicap	104.8	22387	2.3	1.5	-1.9	9.1	8.8	11.7	0.26
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.1	3630	1.6	0.6	-4.5	11.8	9.8	-	0.30
**	Axis Flexi Cap	26.3	12625	1.7	0.6	0.0	12.6	9.4	-	0.24
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	56.1	12937	1.9	1.1	-6.7	17.2	11.1	12.2	0.30
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.7	266	2.1	0.5	6.1	11.3	10.9	-	0.32
**	UTI Flexi Cap	297.5	22248	1.6	1.0	-7.7	7.1	5.3	11.3	0.12
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	97.0	997	3.5	2.4	2.2	11.0	9.7	9.9	0.26
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.3	129	3.3	1.7	-3.1	8.1	7.7	-	0.18
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	218.1	344	2.1	2.0	-2.9	12.0	9.8	9.5	0.28
-	Quant Flexi Cap	106.2	6994	1.8	0.7	9.1	18.1	16.3	19.2	0.45

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	284.0	3282	1.7	0.8	1.1	15.6	14.4	14.1	0.41
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	827.1	17676	1.4	0.8	4.4	18.2	15.6	14.9	0.52
-	Invesco India Multicap	122.6	4079	1.6	0.6	-6.1	13.6	11.4	13.2	0.31
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	36.6	6643	1.6	0.4	4.8	18.2	15.3	-	0.44
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	293.5	53411	1.6	0.9	-1.0	17.1	18.7	15.4	0.60
-	Quant Multi Cap	638.7	7664	1.8	0.7	1.5	12.1	12.0	17.2	0.31
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	367.2	2807	2.0	0.9	-2.0	14.0	12.8	14.4	0.39

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	104.2	16849	1.8	0.6	4.0	22.3	18.5	18.3	0.54
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	198.8	97350	1.3	0.7	4.3	20.3	19.1	17.7	0.62
*****	Quant Mid Cap	216.1	8109	1.8	0.7	-1.2	16.1	15.9	16.8	0.45
*****	Invesco India Midcap	184.2	12397	1.5	0.5	5.7	23.8	19.5	18.3	0.52
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	35.4	4866	1.6	0.4	7.6	21.9	18.0	-	0.52
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	90.6	36458	1.6	0.8	-9.4	16.7	20.3	16.0	0.55
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4340.2	47415	1.5	0.8	5.7	22.5	19.7	18.4	0.60
***	Axis Midcap	115.7	32852	1.6	0.5	3.5	16.9	14.0	16.6	0.42
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	107.2	2461	1.7	0.5	7.4	19.3	15.7	15.4	0.48
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	332.2	7789	1.5	0.9	12.3	24.1	17.9	17.2	0.56
***	Kotak Midcap	139.9	64749	1.4	0.4	5.7	19.7	17.0	17.4	0.51
***	PGIM India Midcap	62.8	10822	2.0	0.8	-1.8	11.6	11.6	15.5	0.35
***	SBI Midcap	230.9	23417	1.6	0.9	-2.0	11.9	14.3	13.6	0.46
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1424.7	13687	1.7	0.9	4.8	21.9	17.8	14.9	0.53
***	Tata Mid Cap	441.1	5732	1.6	0.6	4.1	17.5	15.5	16.0	0.48
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	807.5	6398	1.6	0.9	2.7	18.1	15.3	13.7	0.45
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2659.5	12231	1.5	0.9	-2.5	17.4	14.1	14.1	0.40
**	Taurus Mid Cap	115.4	125	2.1	1.7	-5.1	11.1	11.0	14.5	0.31
**	UTI Mid Cap	297.6	11871	1.7	0.9	-1.3	13.8	12.7	13.9	0.37
**	DSP Midcap	148.4	19673	1.4	0.6	2.7	17.4	11.8	14.4	0.34
**	HSBC Midcap	443.0	14249	3.6	2.5	16.8	26.0	18.3	17.4	0.48
*	LIC MF Midcap	29.3	357	2.4	1.3	-0.1	17.9	13.5	-	0.37

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	173.0	74604	1.4	0.7	2.7	17.9	19.5	20.7	0.53
*****	Quant Small Cap	270.0	31774	1.6	0.7	6.0	19.6	19.7	19.4	0.47
*****	AXIS Small Cap	107.4	27840	1.7	0.7	1.7	15.2	16.2	18.1	0.48

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

*****	Bank of India Small Cap	51.9	2318	1.7	0.5	12.1	21.0	18.7	-	0.46
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	43.8	11717	1.5	0.4	5.7	22.1	19.3	-	0.50
***	DSP Small Cap	208.7	18358	1.4	0.6	5.7	18.2	17.4	16.5	0.46
***	HDFC Small Cap	134.0	38809	1.5	0.7	-2.6	13.6	15.9	17.3	0.44
***	ICICI Pru Smallcap	85.8	8949	1.5	0.7	-1.2	12.8	14.7	16.0	0.48
***	Kotak Small Cap	256.0	17806	1.7	0.6	-2.0	12.9	13.2	16.5	0.36
***	Sundaram Small Cap	275.9	3681	1.9	0.9	7.2	18.4	16.8	14.7	0.45
***	Tata Small Cap	36.0	11645	1.5	0.4	-10.1	11.0	14.2	-	0.38
***	Union Small Cap	54.1	2094	1.8	0.8	15.3	18.7	16.9	16.1	0.43
**	Franklin Ind Small Cap	170.1	13847	1.5	0.8	-2.0	16.1	17.2	14.8	0.45
**	HSBC Small Cap	82.7	16877	1.8	0.7	0.8	15.9	17.7	18.4	0.43
**	SBI Small Cap	170.5	37395	1.6	0.9	0.3	12.4	13.4	17.8	0.38
*	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	91.5	5453	1.6	0.8	6.9	16.5	13.1	12.9	0.34
*	LIC MF Small Cap	31.8	695	2.8	1.5	5.4	17.3	17.2	-	

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %ann	3 Month %ann	6 Month %ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2124.5	748	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.6	6.2	6.0	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	445.6	47520	0.3	0.2	6.6	7.0	6.5	6.2	-
- Axis Liquid	3080.5	56168	0.2	0.1	6.8	7.1	6.5	6.2	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3337.5	17286	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.9	6.4	6.1	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3185.7	1720	0.1	0.1	6.7	6.9	6.5	6.2	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3176.9	11380	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.4	6.1	0.20
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3327.7	7521	0.1	0.1	6.5	7.0	6.4	6.2	-
- DSP Liquidity	3948.3	19019	0.2	0.1	6.7	7.0	6.5	6.2	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3537.7	15222	0.2	0.1	6.8	7.1	6.5	6.2	-
- Groww Liquid	2673.6	262	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.9	6.4	6.2	-
- HDFC Liquid	5424.2	67998	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.9	6.5	6.2	-
- HSBC Liquid	2756.0	16117	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.9	6.4	6.1	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	409.1	58096	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.9	6.4	6.1	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3800.1	14989	0.2	0.1	6.6	7.0	6.5	6.2	-
- ITI Liquid	1437.1	49	0.2	0.2	5.8	6.4	6.0	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	75.4	2147	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.8	6.3	6.1	-
- Kotak Liquid	5586.1	40018	0.3	0.2	6.6	6.9	6.4	6.1	-
- LIC MF Liquid	4997.4	16015	0.2	0.1	6.5	7.0	6.5	6.1	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1799.2	1088	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.9	6.4	6.2	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2897.3	11182	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.8	6.3	6.1	0.40
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.6	937	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.3	5.9	5.7	-
- Navi Liquid	29.9	78	0.2	0.2	5.9	6.0	5.7	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6746.7	31752	0.3	0.2	6.7	7.0	6.5	6.2	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1532.9	5524	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.9	6.4	6.1	-
- PGIM India Liquid	360.0	612	0.2	0.1	6.8	7.1	6.5	6.2	-
- Quant Liquid	43.5	1247	0.6	0.3	5.9	5.8	5.8	5.7	-
- Quantum Liquid	36.9	530	0.3	0.2	5.9	6.0	5.8	5.7	-
- SBI Liquid	4319.7	79363	0.3	0.2	6.7	7.0	6.4	6.1	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2435.7	7657	0.4	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.3	6.0	-
- Tata Liquid	4354.7	30449	0.3	0.2	6.7	6.9	6.4	6.2	-
- Union Liquid	2660.5	8782	0.2	0.1	6.6	6.9	6.4	6.2	-
- UTI Liquid	4537.5	33248	0.3	0.2	6.7	7.0	6.5	6.2	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1485.4	608	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.8	6.3	6.0	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1458.8	9420	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1435.3	11863	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1439.6	813	0.1	0.0	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1380.2	143	0.1	0.1	7.1	5.9	5.5	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1422.6	1255	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1402.9	419	0.7	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1448.9	3002	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1402.3	192	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1414.5	1120	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.4	-
- Groww Overnight	1392.5	212	0.3	0.2	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	3991.1	10587	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1411.8	4681	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1457.1	13075	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1369.8	289	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1367.4	14	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
- JM Overnight	1372.5	310	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
- Kotak Overnight	1442.0	7846	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1398.9	1212	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1398.7	84	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1387.0	2025	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	145.2	7463	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1396.5	63	0.2	0.2	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4364.3	27025	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1434.9	1483	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1425.0	3895	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Union Overnight	1422.1	705	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3683.2	4259	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.0	26280	0.9	0.3	4.9	5.2	5.7	5.7	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.7	9781	2.5	1.8	4.8	5.3	5.8	5.7	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.1	8189	0.9	0.3	4.7	5.1	5.5	5.4	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.5	48	0.9	0.4	3.4	4.6	5.4	5.4	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.9	1272	0.9	0.3	4.9	4.9	5.4	5.4	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.7	6382	0.9	0.3	4.7	5.2	5.7	5.6	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.4	14862	3.3	2.7	5.2	5.3	5.8	5.7	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.3	25085	0.8	0.4	5.4	5.5	5.9	5.8	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.0	2667	2.3	1.7	5.1	5.4	5.9	5.7	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.2	32260	0.8	0.3	4.7	5.3	5.8	5.7	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.7	28062	0.9	0.3	5.4	5.4	5.9	5.9	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.7	88	0.9	0.3	3.2	4.6	5.8	5.7	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.3	369	1.5	0.8	4.4	5.0	5.5	5.4	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.5	72079	1.0	0.4	5.1	5.5	5.9	5.8	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.6	239	0.9	0.3	5.0	5.7	5.9	5.6	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.0	121	1.0	0.3	4.6	5.0	5.3	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.7	3643	0.8	0.1	4.5	4.9	5.6	5.5	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.0	16294	2.8	2.1	5.3	5.4	5.8	5.7	0.80
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.3	92	1.0	0.4	5.3	5.6	5.8	5.4	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.7	43266	2.3	1.8	4.8	5.4	5.9	5.8	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.2	468	1.0	0.3	5.3	5.8	6.1	5.8	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.2	22760	0.9	0.3	4.9	5.4	5.9	5.7	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.8	242	0.9	0.3	4.8	5.3	5.6	5.5	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.0	10991	4.4	3.9	5.1	5.3	5.8	5.8	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Savings	581.0	19611	0.5	0.3	6.2	7.2	7.2	6.4	10.92
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Dur	1632.5	775	0.4	0.3	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.3	-
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4259.3	10938	1.1	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.8	6.5	19.13
★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.1	4440	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.0	-
★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.3	16002	0.7	0.3	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.1	9.63
★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1385.3	1715	0.4	0.2	6.1	7.0	7.1	6.2	5.98
★★★★	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4470.1	3997	1.0	0.4	5.7	6.5	6.7	6.4	8.59
★★★★	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.5	6168	1.2	0.4	5.6	6.4	6.5	5.7	10.59
★★★★	DSP Ultra Short	3590.1	4711	0.9	0.3	5.6	6.5	6.6	5.7	6.37
★★★★	HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.0	16658	0.7	0.4	5.8	6.7	6.9	6.0	5.31
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1433.4	3525	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
★★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2848.1	1197	0.7	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.8	5.8	4.42
★★★★	Kotak Savings	45.3	16186	0.8	0.4	5.8	6.6	6.7	5.9	5.79
★★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1454.2	213	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.7	6.8	6.0	4.69
★★★★	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6315.8	11861	0.6	0.4	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.0	8.98
★★★★	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1433.5	560	1.1	0.6	5.5	6.3	6.4	5.6	-
★★★★	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3333.0	140	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.3	6.3	5.6	7.86
★★★★	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1391.5	371	1.4	0.2	5.5	6.3	6.3	5.5	1.46
★★★★	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.8	175	1.0	0.4	5.4	6.2	6.4	5.6	2.86
★★★★	Tata Ultra Short Term	15.0	5454	1.0	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.7	10.03
★★★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4002.5	528	0.8	0.3	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.5	-
★★★★	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.3	380	1.2	0.2	5.0	5.5	5.7	4.9	-
★★★★	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2813.3	2331	1.4	0.2	4.9	5.8	5.9	5.2	1.33

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

★★★★★	ICICI Pru Savings	576.4	25885	0.5	0.4	6.1	7.3	7.4	6.5	7.01
★★★★★	UTI Low Duration	3754.4	3151	0.4	0.3	5.9	7.1	7.1	7.3	6.97
★★★★★	Axis Treasury Advantage	3272.6	5803	0.7	0.4	5.9	7.1	7.1	6.2	8.24
★★★★★	DSP Low Duration	20.9	4773	0.5	0.3	5.5	6.8	6.8	6.0	-
★★★★★	HDFC Low Duration	60.9	20218	1.1	0.5	5.6	6.8	6.9	6.0	14.47

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
★★★★★	HSBC Low Duration	30.3	1012	0.9	0.4	5.8	7.6	7.5	6.3	10.14
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	690.8	13011	1.0	0.4	5.3	6.5	6.6	5.8	9.81
★★★★	Bandhan Low Duration	40.7	5811	0.6	0.3	5.6	6.8	6.8	5.9	-
★★★★	Canara Robeco Savings	44.5	1099	0.4	0.2	5.7	6.9	6.9	6.0	-
★★★★	Invesco India Low Duration	3992.8	1849	0.5	0.3	5.6	6.8	6.9	5.9	5.23
★★★★	JM Low Duration	39.1	227	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.8	6.8	5.8	3.29
★★★★	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3952.2	9359	1.0	0.4	5.7	6.9	6.8	6.0	8.64
★★★★	SBI Low Duration	3674.8	13167	0.9	0.4	5.3	6.6	6.7	5.8	4.01
★★★★	Tata Treasury Advantage	4153.1	2755	0.5	0.2	5.7	6.9	6.9	6.0	3.80
★★★★	Kotak Low Duration	3521.5	13370	1.2	0.4	5.4	6.7	6.7	5.8	11.98
★★★★	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1723.2	550	0.9	0.3	5.6	6.6	6.7	5.7	13.80
★★★★	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2381.2	2176	0.7	0.2	5.5	6.7	6.8	5.8	5.27
★★★★	Sundaram Low Duration	3633.1	364	1.1	0.4	5.1	6.5	6.5	5.7	2.66
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.2	293	0.9	0.2	5.4	6.5	6.6	5.7	1.61
★★★★	LIC MF Low Duration	41.7	1608	0.5	0.3	5.5	6.6	6.6	5.7	6.40

